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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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Correction of errors of substance may be made only on the floor of the House with the permission of the Speaker. However, correction of typographical or grammatical errors which Members suggest for the Bound Volumes which will be compiled at the end of the Meeting may be clearly marked in the Daily Report, and the copy containing the corrections submitted at the Editor's Office, Parliament House, not later than four clear days after the publication of the Daily Report.

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Thursday, 17th July, 2025

The House met at 2.36 p.m.

[THE SPEAKER IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, we
would take the item numbered 3—
Message from the President.

**COMMUNICATION FROM THE
PRESIDENT**

The Speaker: Hon Members, I have
two messages from His Excellency the
President. These messages came in
earlier, but due to my absence, they could
not be read to the House.

The first is dated 9th July, 2025 and it
reads:



REPUBLIC OF GHANA

Jubilee House



The President

9th July, 2025

Rt. Hon. Speaker,

NOMINATION OF DEPUTY MINISTERS

In accordance with Article 79(1) of the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992, I respectfully submit, through you, to Parliament for prior approval, the names of the following persons I intend to appoint as Deputy Ministers, upon consultation with the relevant Ministers of State.

	MINISTRY	NAME
1.	Ministry of Transport	Dorcas Toffey, MP
2.	Ministry of Foreign Affairs	James G. Quayson, MP
3.	Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations	Mohammed Adam Sukparu, MP
4.	Ministry of Health	Grace Ayensu-Danquah, MP

The nominees have distinguished themselves in public service and possess the requisite qualifications, experience and integrity to support the respective sector Ministers in effectively discharging their duties.

Their curricula vitae and supporting documents are attached to facilitate the vetting process. I trust that Parliament will consider and approve the nominations expeditiously.

Please accept, Mr. Speaker, the assurances of my highest consideration.


JOHN DRAMANI MAHAMA

**RT. HON. SPEAKER OF PARLIAMENT
 PARLIAMENT OF GHANA
 PARLIAMENT HOUSE
 ACCRA**

2.46 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I accordingly refer these Nominees to the Appointments Committee for the usual consideration which involves public hearing and report to the House.

You are not compelled to consider them expeditiously. They are wholly in our hands. Please do the right thing. They are so referred.

The second message is dated 11th July, 2025.



REPUBLIC OF GHANA

Jubilee House

The President

11th July, 2025

Rt. Hon. Speaker,

ABSENCE FROM GHANA

In accordance with Article 59 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, I write to formally notify you of my intention to travel to Malabo, Equatorial Guinea on 12th July, 2025 to participate in the 7th Mid-Year Coordination Meeting between the African Union, Regional Economic Communities and Regional Mechanisms, scheduled to take place on Sunday, 13th July, 2025. I shall return on the same day.

In my absence, the Vice President, Professor Naana Jane Opoku-Agyemang, shall perform my functions in accordance with Article 60(8) of the Constitution.



JOHN DRAMANI MAHAMA

**THE RT. HON. SPEAKER
OFFICE OF PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA**

cc: The Vice President
Jubilee House
Accra

The Chief of Staff
Jubilee House
Accra

The Speaker: Hon Members, let me, in reference to the item numbered 4, rather make a Statement, not a formal communication.

STATEMENT BY THE SPEAKER

Visit to the Assemblée Parlementaire de la Francophonie (APF)

The Speaker: I want to bring you warm greetings from the Parliament of the Republic of France where I happily, with your Leadership and some Members, represented this august House. This is our first attendance at the Francophonie Parliament Session as a fully admitted Member of that Parliament. Ghana used to attend as an observer, but we have worked, and as we all know, right from the former regime up to this regime, we were formally admitted into the Francophonie in 2024. The Parliament of Ghana has now been formally admitted as a member of the Assemblée Parlementaire de la Francophonie (APF). [*Hear! Hear!*]

On your behalf, I spoke French, and your Leaders were there to support me. It was well received. Even though I read the message in English, I spoke French. I am sure I will share that with you later. At least I recalled my Form 1 and Form 2 French, and surprisingly, it was well received. My memory is still very good.

So, this will become one of the statutory conferences that this House will have to attend annually. We believe that we will also put a system in place for Members to start learning the French language, more than you are doing.

Because, as you know, in the sub-region we are completely engulfed by French-speaking countries and we need to be able to work together. This is towards strengthening not only the bilateral relations, but multilateralism, and more importantly, the fast-evolving function of Parliament referred to as Parliamentary Diplomacy.

So, I took time to meet the officials and to draw their attention to the fact that we already have, apart from the Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration, a Ghana-France Parliamentary Friendship Association and we will definitely facilitate the usual benchmarking visits and friendly visits of the two countries. So, Members, this notice is to get you in preparation to effectively represent our beloved country, Ghana, any time the opportunity knocks at our door. So, please, this is what kept me away from the House for some days, and hence the delay in reading these communications to you.

With this, I thank you for your attention.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

The Speaker: We move on to the item numbered 5, Correction of *Votes* and *Proceedings* and the *Official Report*. We will start with the Correction of *Votes* and *Proceedings* of Wednesday, 16th July, 2025.

Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on Page 9, the item numbered 7 (b) *248, the second line “To ask the Minister for the Lands and Natural Resources...”, I suggest we delete “the”. So, it remains “To ask the Minister for Lands...” not “The Lands...”.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes. Table Office, kindly take note of that.

Page 10 ... 12?

Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on Page 12, under the item numbered 9, Motion, “Moved by the Hon Minister for Education, Mr Haruna Iddrisu, on behalf of the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development”. The current designation for the Ministry does not have development. It should be “Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture”.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Table Office, kindly take note of that.

Page 13—

Yes, please. Sorry.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. On Page 12 and consequentially Page 13, the title of

the Hon Minister for Education, as seen in Page 4, is “Alhaji Iddrisu, Haruna”.

2.56 p.m.

So, I just wanted to be clear whether the title should be “Mr” or “Alhaji”. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Well, I have just been informed that he does not use “Alhaji” and so, page 4 would rather be corrected. Thank you so much. Actually, I did not know he was an Alhaji. Are you sure he performed the Hajj? He was around, but he is not on the Floor.

Page 13...14—

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, under 17, clause 2 — “Amendment proposed”, the spelling of “paragraph”, there is a “p” in between “r-a” and it is repeated on page 15 consequentially. So, I will seek your guidance for it to be corrected.

The Speaker: Yes, Table Office kindly do the right thing.

Page 15...19—

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, on page 19, under “Opening”, the Committee met on Tuesday, 14th July. This said date was supposed to be 15th July because, Monday was 14th and Tuesday was 15th.

The Speaker: Table Office, please kindly make that correction.

Page 20...21.

Sorry, that is not an Hon Member.

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 16th July, 2025, as corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, we have the *Official Report* of Tuesday, 8th July, 2025 for correction.

Any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Tuesday, 8th July, 2025]

The Speaker: Hon Members, we have in our midst members of the Parliamentary Service Commission of the Parliament of Malawi. They are on a study tour to our Parliament. I have the pleasure on your behalf to introduce them to you and with your kind permission I start with the First Deputy Speaker, the leader of the delegation in the person of Hon Madalitso Kazombo — *[Hear! Hear!]*—Hon Member, are you available?

Hon Madalitso Kazombo. *[Hear! Hear!]*

You may rise to be recognised—Sorry.

I am told that the First Deputy Speaker could not make it—He was recalled. That is the nature of the business. Sometimes you can be ordered mid-air to return.

The second person is a Member of Parliament by name, Commissioner George Zulu. Also recalled? So, who is not recalled? —*[Laughter]*

So, I can mention only that. The rest are available. So, I move on.

We have a Member of Parliament also by name—Oh, the Commissioner is a title not a name. Because you are members of the Commission. So, we have Hon Lillian Patel, Member of Parliament; Hon Chrispin Mphande; Hon Ackson Kalaile Banda; Mr Chikondi Kachinjika, the Deputy Clerk of Parliament; The Personal Assistant to the Commission is Mr Sunge Kalumo; Then we have the Head of Policy and Planning, Mr Lovemore Nyongo; We have Head of Protocol, Public Relations and Civic Education, Mr Ian Mwenye. Also recalled? Sorry. Now, the delegation is accompanied by Dr Rasheed Draman, the Executive Director, African Centre for Parliamentary Affairs (ACEPA). You all know him very well. He is always here with us.

Hon Members, the Commission is here, among other things, to gain a comprehensive understanding of Parliamentary corporate governance and share best practises in the governance and management of Parliaments. The delegation will familiarise themselves with the structure, operations and facilities of our Parliament. You know very well that Dr Rasheed Draman of ACEPA is globally involved in the training of both Members of Parliament and staff of various Parliaments, as I

said, globally, in the world. So, on behalf of the House, I want to warmly welcome the delegation to Parliament and wish them fruitful deliberations.

I urge all Members and staff concerned to make themselves available and to share whatever knowledge and experience they have with our brothers and sisters from the Republic of Malawi.

[Delegation from the Parliamentary Service Commission of Malawi were acknowledged]

3.06 p.m.

The Speaker: Once again, you are warmly welcome.

We also have, as usual, our visitors, mostly, from various institutions and they can be found at the Public Gallery. We have from Koforidua Technical University as many as 63 students, led by one of their lecturers by name Isaac Kpabi. Koforidua Technical University is located in the New Juaben South Constituency. I know the Member of Parliament will have had some hand in their presence here and I want to, on behalf of the Member and the House, warmly welcome you to your House. This is your Parliament and anytime, our doors are widely open to receive you; you are welcome. You may kindly resume your seats.

[Students from the Koforidua Technical University were acknowledged]

The Speaker: We also have a delegation from the Akatsi College of Education made up of 65 members, led by the lecturer by name Bridget Aku Dorkenoo. This College of Education is located in the Akatsi South Constituency—I did not hear— **[Some Hon Members:** First Deputy Speaker o! Speaker!]**]**—Your Speaker has managed to bring as many as 65 members from the College of Education—*[Hear! Hear!]*—So, you should congratulate him.

You are mostly welcome and I do not need to tell you that your Member of Parliament is the First Deputy Speaker and he is always ready and willing to receive you, so kindly take the opportunity. Maybe, after some years, you will not have another Member like him, so, please, you are warmly welcome. Resume your seats.

[Students from Akatsi College of Education were acknowledged]

The Speaker: We also have 57 members from Bomso M/A Junior High School. They are led by the headteacher by name Fofie Peter. The Junior High School can be found in the Oforikrom Constituency. As I said, they are 57 in number. Please, you are also warmly welcome and once again, you can come anytime because we want you to learn better than we are doing and perform better than this in future. Please, you may resume your seats.

[Pupils from Bomso M/ A Junior High School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: We now have 43 members from the Alajo '1' Basic School. They are led by one of their teachers by name Evans Akure. The Alajo '1' Basic School is located in the Ayawaso Central Constituency. Once again, you can see them at the Public Gallery and on your behalf, I also warmly welcome them and our doors are, once again, open for them. Anytime they want, they can come. Do not come only in a group; you can come even as individuals and you will be admitted here. We have a team to always take you through the rudiments of Parliament and parliamentary practice, so you are lucky to have this opportunity. Some of us did not have that. I got the opportunity when I was in the university, not in the basic school. So, you are welcome. Kindly resume your seats.

[Pupils from Alajo '1' Basic School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: Hon Members, we now move on to the item numbered 6, Urgent Questions. We have two Urgent Questions for the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources. The first one stands in the name of Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam, the Member of Parliament for Pru East.

Please, Hon Member, you may ask your Question now.

URGENT QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF WORKS, HOUSING AND WATER RESOURCES

Plans to Provide Parambo-Sawaba with Safe and Sustainable Water

Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam (NDC — Pru East): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and

Water Resources what plans the Ministry is implementing to ensure that Parambo-Sawaba Community is provided with safe and sustainable water in the shortest possible time.

Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources (Mr Kenneth Gilbert Adjei): Mr Speaker, the Parambo-Sawaba community has an old abandoned small town water supply system, consisting of a surface water production and a treatment plant located at Parambo-Nsuono on the Lake Volta with about 180-metre cube concrete high-level tank. The transmission and distribution pipe networks are of the unplasticised polyvinyl chloride (UPVC) material. Major rehabilitation is required to revive the operation of the water supply system. In addition, the intake and control room will also require reconstruction.

Mr Speaker, an alternative solution of using groundwater to serve the Parambo and surrounding communities like Sawaba is not feasible. These are significant challenges associated with groundwater within the enclave, such as high salinity levels, possible bacteriological contamination of the groundwater sources and low safe yields of boreholes.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry and the Community Water and Sanitation Agency (CWSA) have earmarked the rehabilitation and expansion of the Parambo-Sawaba water system as part of the projects to be undertaken in the rural water sector within the medium-term as part of the Big Push, a national

infrastructure development programme. The construction duration from commencement to completion is 18 calendar months, once the needed funds are secured.

Mr Speaker, the project proposal is to reconstruct the abandoned slow sand filtration water system at Parambo, converting it into a rapid sand filtration system and the installation of an integrated purifier to increase the water production capacity.

The proposal also includes the construction of a new floating intake, new water treatment plant, clear water tank, the installation of low lift and high lift pump, and the laying of about 25,000 metres of High-Density Polyethylene (HDPE) transmission pipeline and 18,000 metres of distribution pipe network to cover not only Parambo-Sawaba but also Prang, the district capital of the Pru West District.

Other communities to benefit from the implementation of the project include Bankama, Domeabra, Laban, Kofi Basare, Labun Quarters, Kojokrom, Nakpe, Kunkude in the Pru East and Pru West Districts.

3.16p.m.

Mr Speaker, the implementation of this project will address the water demand for the Parambo-Sawaba-Prang area for the next 35 years and will enhance the well-being of the population within their respective communities.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Boam: Mr Speaker, no supplementary question. Only to show my appreciation to the Hon Minister for such an in-depth explanation and pray that the needed funds will be secured as early as possible, so that the project can commence.

The Speaker: Hon Member, do not only pray; make sure you follow up and pressurise the Ministry and all development partners to come to your support. Prayer alone will not save you.
[Laughter]

Mr Boam: Well noted, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Thank you.

Hon Members, the next Question stands in the name of Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei, Hon Member of Parliament for Bekwai.

Strategies to Prevent Flood-Induced Contamination of Water Resources in Flood-prone Areas

Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei (NPP — Bekwai): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources what strategies the Ministry is implementing to prevent flood-induced contamination of water resources in flood-prone areas like Chorkor and La Dade-Kotopon, and how these measures will protect Public Health during the rainy season.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, across the country, especially in flood-prone areas such as low-lying coastal zones, Chorkor and La Dade-Kotopon, informal settlements and floodplains along major rivers, floodwaters pose a major threat to water quality and public safety.

Floodwaters often mix with solid and liquid waste, as well as industrial pollutants, leading to contamination of drinking water sources. The public health implications are severe, including cholera outbreaks, diarrhoea disease, typhoid and other water and sanitation-related vector-borne diseases.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry, knowing the adverse effects of floodwaters on drinking water sources, has developed some key strategies to effectively prevent flood-induced contamination of water resources in flood-prone areas to protect public health during the rainy season.

One such key strategy is the provision of resilient water infrastructure, such as the construction of elevated boreholes, wells and storage tanks above flood levels, as well as incorporation of climate resilience into the design of water supply systems as outlined in the 2023 Water, Sanitation and Hygiene System Resilience Study, which was conducted with support from UNICEF.

The study provided a detailed analysis of the disaster risk landscape of Ghana and outlines proactive strategies to ensure continuous and resilient water services. These infrastructure improvements reduce direct contact

between floodwaters and water supplies, which is the first line of defence against contamination.

Mr Speaker, it is important to note that the Ghana Water Limited, and Community Water and Sanitation Agency, as part of the implementation of their water safety plans, have put in mitigation measures to ensure the safe delivery of water supply services to all communities in the country, including Chorkor and La Dade-Kotopon communities. That notwithstanding, the Ministry is also working with the various Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs) to ensure that water systems under the management of the stakeholders adhere to laid down regulations and standards in relation to the design, construction and operation of water supply systems.

Mr Speaker, another key strategy is the improvement of the urban drainage system by ensuring that we upgrade and maintain stormwater drainage systems and at the same time, ensure that stormwater drains do not discharge themselves into water points. To this end, the Greater Accra Resilient and Integrated Development Project (GARID) is making efforts to improve upon the drainage situation for beneficiary communities in the Greater Accra Metropolitan area, which includes Chorkor and La Dade-Kotopon.

In addition, the Ministry, with its water supply agencies, is rolling out a water safety campaign to create awareness among various stakeholders at all levels on their roles in ensuring the

safety of water from the source of the point of use. Key activities include training community watch champions on water protection in emergencies, as well as promotion of household-level drinking water protection, and purification water hygiene methods such as chlorination, boiling and filtering of water before usage.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry is committed to ensuring that Ghana water supply systems are protected against the increasing threat of floods by acting decisively. We will uphold our mandate to provide safe water for all, even in the face of climate and environmental shocks.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Poku-Adusei: Mr Speaker, I want to commend the Minister for a comprehensive Answer. Mr Speaker, on that note, I do not think a follow up question will be necessary.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members that is the end of Urgent Questions.

We will now move to item number 7, which deals with the major Questions which were submitted on notice.

Hon Minister, you know how important Chorkor is? You do not know? Chorkor is a very important community in Accra. They assisted in developing

one of our best human resources that has been globally acclaimed as the father of education in Africa, Dr Kwegyir Aggrey. He spent the early part of his life living in Chorkor. So, it is a very important community and, please, let us see how we can augment their standard of living.

If you want more information, I can give them to you. Yes. His father was a king, King Amunu—Rather, his father was a linguist. So, you now understand why he was so good in language. His father was a linguist.

Yes, Minority Leader, it is your turn now. Question number 268 stands in your name and you are to ask the Minister for Works, Housing, and Water Resources. You may do so now.

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, welcome back. I am happy to see you. We always learn from you and continue to tap into your wisdom.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to ask my Question as advertised as Question number 268. With respect, I will proceed.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF WORKS, HOUSING AND WATER RESOURCES

Extent of Effect of Illegal Mining on Water Bodies

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin (NPP—Effutu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the extent illegal mining is affecting water-

bodies used as raw water intake points and what steps the Ghana Water Company Limited is taking to ensure the production of potable water for the general public.

The Speaker: Yes, Minister?

3.26 p.m

Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources (Mr Kenneth Gilbert Adjei): Mr Speaker, illegal mining, popularly referred to as *Galamsey*, is having a devastating effect on several water bodies across the country, including those that serve as raw water sources for public water supply systems. Major rivers such as the Pra, Birim, Densu, Anum, Oda, Ankobra, Tano, Offin and Black Volta have been significantly polluted due to illegal and environmentally destructive mining activities.

Mr Speaker, Ghana Water Limited (GWL) has reported alarming turbidity levels in the afore-mentioned water bodies. For example, the Pra River has recorded turbidity levels as high as 8,350 Nephelometric Turbidity Units (NTU) at Daboase in the Western Region, far exceeding the design threshold of 2,000 NTU for the Daboase Water treatment plant and 100 NTU for most water treatment plants. Similarly, at the Sekyere Hemang intake in the Central Region, the activities of illegal mining have resulted in the siltation of the Pra River, thereby reducing the volume of raw water intake by up to 60 per cent. This situation has forced GWL to operate

at only 25 per cent of its treatment capacity.

Mr Speaker, these conditions have increased the operational costs of water production significantly due to the use of:

- (i) Alternative coagulants (Polymers) which are more potent in treating highly turbid raw water; and
- (ii) The usage of more volumes of other chemicals for water treatment.

Mr Speaker, to put the cost implications into perspective, the price of polymers is four times as much as the price of traditional coagulants such as aluminium sulphate used for water treatment in areas where the water source has not been polluted as a result of illegal or *galamsey* activities. The deterioration or pollution of the water bodies caused by illegal mining often leads to the breakdown of GWL's pumping equipment, resulting in frequent pump equipment maintenance which also comes with a high attendant cost and increased power consumption. All these challenges have culminated to intermittent water supply and rationing in several urban centres in the Eastern, Central and Western Regions of the country.

Mr Speaker, in response to these challenges, GWL has instituted several mitigation measures, including:

1. Emergency dredging of intake points that have been heavily silted by illegal mining activities, especially along the Pra River. Dredging of the intake areas of the Daboase, Baifikrom and Sekyere Hemang Water treatment plant was recently undertaken using Internally Generated Funds.
2. Construction and upgrading of treatment facilities, such as the expansion of the Sekondi–Takoradi plant, to handle relatively higher turbidity levels above 2000 NTU. It is worth noting that any deterioration of the river bodies beyond the operating range of water treatment plants leads to a reduction in their production volumes.
3. Enhanced stakeholder collaboration is being undertaken with the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), Regional Security Councils, Water Resources Commission, and the recently commissioned “water guards” to map and protect raw water sources and their catchments.
4. Public sensitisation campaigns in collaboration with traditional leaders and civil society groups to raise awareness about the threat of illegal mining to national water security.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry through the of Ghana Water Limited will continue to

monitor the quality of raw water sources they abstract for treatment and subsequent supply and will enhance treatment processes in the face of these escalating challenges to ensure the delivery of safe water to the general population within the operational areas of Ghana Water Limited.

Mr Speaker, I am of the belief that the renewed, sustained and coordinated efforts initiated will enhance the long-term sustainability of safe water supply in the country.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, any supplementary question?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Rightly so. Mr Speaker, the Minister in his Answer has shared with us the challenges faced by GWL. He first talked about the production capacity, which is up to just 25 per cent, and also the costs of producing water having gone up astronomically as a result of these *galamsey* activities.

Mr Speaker, in view of the response of the Minister, and given the fact that on May Day, the Secretary General of Organised Labour had this to say, and I read:

“We Organised Labour are surprised that five months into this administration, *galamsey* menace is getting worse.”

Mr Speaker, would he provide timelines in respect of the sensitisation?

Because, according to him, indeed the *galamsey* activities are getting out of hand, and Organised Labour is also concerned. He talked about sensitisation. Would he provide some timelines for this sensitisation programme that he just referred to?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, our Standing Orders, in Order 86(1) (b) says:

“A Question shall not

(b) contain charges which the Member asking the Question is not in a position to substantiate;

Mr Speaker, the Hon Minority Leader will not be able to substantiate his charge that *galamsey* is getting out of hands just five months after the National Democratic Congress (NDC) has come into office. That is a charge.

Even if he claims he is quoting the Trades Union Congress (TUC), he should let the TUC say it out there. They can say it, but in this House, when one says something, that person should be in a position to substantiate it. That is the position.

3.36 p.m.

If he is going to say that *galamsey* has got out of hand five months into the National Democratic Congress (NDC) administration, he should be able to substantiate that charge. That is what our Standing Orders say. He should not hide

under the cover of a TUC statement, because anybody can say anything out there, but not in this Chamber. If the TUC comes to this Chamber and makes that statement, we will ask them to substantiate it. Same way, if he hides under the cover of TUC to make that statement, we will ask him to substantiate it. If he is unable to substantiate it, then he will have to withdraw it.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, I have always said that the Majority Leader should have been a *sheikh*, because he does not know mischief. When he is being mischievous, we see the smiles on his face.

After admitting my question and the Minister got to the despatch box to answer, he belatedly came in to raise an objection. Admissibility of a Question, Mr Speaker—[Interruption]—Leader, can I finish?

Mr Ayariga: You are always smiling.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: As for smiles, we all learnt it from Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker will not make you upset, he will give you some smile just to make you relax. Mr Speaker, admissibility of a Question is your sole mandate. He cannot chip away your powers.

Mr Speaker, you have admitted my supplementary question, then you asked the Minister to answer. Then the Majority Leader belatedly comes in to say that no, he disagrees. Mr Speaker, he

is not the best person to interpret the Rules; you have interpreted the Rules. I asked the question twice. On the first occasion, he said, “Minister, sit down. Let him repeat”, I repeated it then you allowed it. So, he is trying to do his politics and we have got him. He wants to protect Government, that is okay.

But the question has been asked. I brought the TUC position and it is because the Minister said that the *galamsey* situation has really affected Ghana Water Limited in terms of production and their pumping machines, and they are relying on some new chemicals which are even more expensive. Then, he said that they are operating at 25 per cent capacity. Mr Speaker, may I read paragraph 2? He says that,

“Mr Speaker, these conditions have increased the operational costs of water production significantly due to the use of:

- (iii) Alternative coagulants (Polymers) which are more potent in treating highly turbid raw water and
- (iv) The usage of more volumes of other chemicals for water treatment”.

Mr Speaker, based on this, he himself went further to say that they are doing sensitisation. So, I only brought the TUC bit to corroborate what he has just told the House of Parliament, to say that he

should give us the timelines for the sensitisation programme they have embarked upon. Mr Speaker, that is all; sensitisation programme. It is contained in his Answer. The Government will not call the Majority Leader. It is all right; he has done his work. The Speaker has allowed the question, let him answer.

The Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, ordinarily, people ask their questions and ordinarily, Speakers will allow. But if somebody raises an objection to a question and then provides one of the Rules as the basis for the objection and cites the Rule as grounds for making a case that somebody is out of order, the Speaker has to take a decision. The portions of his question in which he seeks to make part of the record of this House, a claim that *galamsey* has gone out of hand five months into the administration of this Government, is what I take offence in. I am saying that it offends the Standing Orders because the Standing Orders expect us to be able to substantiate a charge if we make that charge. But he is unable to substantiate it, then he goes to quote somebody else and says that this person says that *galamsey* has got out of hand within five months of the NDC coming into office.

I am saying that he cannot substantiate that and he cannot, in this House, rely on what that person has said because that person will not be able to substantiate that in this House. So, he should withdraw that portion. If he wants to ask about sensitisation, he should ask him about sensitisation. As for smiling, it is

my nature. I will smile even if I am boiling a person with hot water; that is my nature. I do not know how to frown because frowning is not good.

The Speaker: Please, may we allow the Minister to answer the question? The Majority Leader has done his duty. So please, Minister?

Mr Adjei: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. The sensitisation is ongoing until the good people of Ghana stop the *galamsey* menace. Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, supplementary question?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: The Hon Minister has been very profound in his Answer that the sensitisation will go on until, I am quoting him, “the good people of Ghana stop the *galamsey*”. Now, since the sensitisation will go on, may I know from him whether he has secured any budgetary allocation to support this drive? Or, it is only Ghana Water Limited that is relying on its Internally Generated Fund (IGF) to undertake this sensitisation programme. I say so because according to him, the situation is getting out of hand, and he needs—*[Interruption]*—Yes, it is in the report; it is there. Yes, please, pay attention. And that chiefs, opinion leaders, community leaders, traditional leaders are all being engaged to assist.

So, the question is on the budget for this sensitisation programme. Thank you very much.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Adjei: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Currently, Ghana Water Limited is using its IGF for that sensitisation. Thank you.

The Speaker: Your last supplementary question.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, under the new dispensation, it has been increased to five under Order 89 (3). But Mr Speaker, if you want to limit it to three—but Mr Speaker, the new Rules—

The Speaker: Can you read the Rule properly?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Yes, please. Mr Speaker, with respect—

The Speaker: Order 89 (3).

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Order 89 (3). “Any Member—

The Speaker: Please, that is not Order 89 (3).

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Oh, Mr Speaker, the one I have here –

4.11 p.m.

The Speaker: What does Order 89(3) say?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Order 89 (3) says: “Any other Member...” — **The Speaker:** Exactly.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: It says:

“Any other Member may be allowed to ask no more than two Supplementary Questions except that the Majority and Minority Leaders or co-leaders may each ask not more than five Supplementary Questions on the substantive Questions.”

Yes, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: So, what does the Rule say? Does it say that you are allowed to ask up to five?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, not more than five.

The Speaker: Please, “may”—
[*Laughter*]

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you taught us the Rules. Mr Speaker, today is your first day. Today, when I started, I was happy seeing you in the Chair. The Rules—The “may” says “not more than five”. Mr Speaker, do not limit me to three. It says that not more than five. I will take it again, so you should patiently bear with me as I read:

“Any other Member may be allowed to ask no more than two...”

So, it means that, for other Members, it is not more than two supplementary questions,

“... except that the Majority and Minority Leaders or co-leaders may ask not more than five”.

Mr Speaker, if you grant me the opportunity, it means I cannot go more than five. So, I am only pleading.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please, on the question of supplementary questions, Order 89(1) is clear:

“(1) As soon as a Question is answered, any Member, beginning with the Member who asked the Question, may, without notice, ask a Supplementary Question for further clarification of any matter or fact on the answer but a Supplementary Question shall not introduce a matter not included in the original question.

(2) The Member who asked a Question may be allowed to ask not more than three Supplementary Questions on the substantive Question.

(3) Any other Member may be allowed to ask not more than two Supplementary Questions except that the Majority and Minority Leaders or co-leaders may each ask not more than five Supplementary Questions on the substantive Question”.

This one is referring to a Member asking a Question and when it comes to supplementary, the Leaders are permitted to ask more. But when the Leader himself asks a Question, this is not applicable.

Minority Leader, do you want me to bend the Rules?

Yes, Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, the Minority Leader raised a legal issue and the Speaker was given an interpretation and he gave his occiput to the Speaker—**[Some Members of the Majority:** That is unfortunate]—Yes, he gave his occiput to the Speaker while he was trying to explain a Rule to him. This is not good. This is in bad taste.

Mr Speaker, it is not a good mannerism. He has done that persistently; I have observed him. When the Speaker is addressing us, we are all facing him with rapt attention. But when he raised an issue and the Speaker was addressing it, he looked elsewhere and his occiput to the Speaker—**[Interruption]**—No, he has done that several times.

Indeed, it is worse when the First Deputy Speaker is in the Chair. Mr Speaker, he will not only sit and give his occiput to the Speaker, he will face this Side and be addressing the Speaker—**[Interruption]**—No, he has done it persistently. When it was the First Deputy Speaker, I kept quiet because he is our Colleague Member of Parliament. But I cannot keep quiet when it is the Speaker. I cannot do that. And while he is doing that, he is attacking a woman on this Side—**[Some Hon Members:** Ei!]**]**—He just did. The Speaker had to draw his attention that he should concentrate and ask his Question. He was

attacking the women. These things must stop—**[Interruption]**—This is not below the belt; it is the conduct that is below the belt. Please, let us respect each other in this Chamber.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh —*rose*—

Mr Speaker: Well, I thought once the Minority Leader was here himself, unless he has engaged counsel—

The Speaker: Minority Chief Whip, are you the counsel now?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, not necessarily, but I am his Chief Whip.

The Speaker: All right.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it is just to observe a few things that the Leader of the House has related to.

Mr Speaker, today, at the Business Committee, the Leader of the House and the Majority Leader regretted how we have often delayed in prosecuting Government Business and he zeroed in on Question Time, referenced the Orders and said that we have often yielded to the temptation of going beyond the stipulated time and Government Business often suffers. I agreed with him totally. Here we are, we are just about exiting Question Time and he is the same person engaging in businesses and observations that will be drawing us backwards and then he will later on come and lament.

Mr Speaker, for the record, this week we have shown total cooperation with

our Colleagues. Even where Deputy Ministers and Ministers are not in the House, we have willingly obliged where applications are made to the Chair that Deputy Ministers or other Ministers lay or prosecute Businesses that are advertised in the name of different Ministries.

Why will not he allow us to go ahead and exhaust the period allocated to Question Time? Then, Government Business will be prosecuted. Here he is raising issues that will not inure to the benefits of the prosecution of Government Business. Why?

3.56 p.m.

Mr Majority Leader, in one breath, you want us to support you to prosecute Government Business, then in another breath—You are the same person who is causing the delay. Mr Speaker, I want to be charitable here and I want to be careful in the use of words.

When the Majority Leader does such things, he is delaying Government Business and I am sure the President will not be happy with this. The President wants Government Business to be prosecuted and here he is raising things that will not help. So, he should advise himself. Otherwise, we will help him to delay the prosecution of Government Business, which would not be in his interest. A word to the wise, is enough.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please, may we proceed and take note of the exchanges that have taken place. We have taken note of it, but, please, let us proceed.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister, in his Response, which is advertised in the Order Paper at page 15, shares with us certain mitigation measures that have been instituted and he lists four of them. One out of the four he has already addressed. The other three include emergency dredging of intake points, the construction and upgrading of treatment facilities, and the third one is that he has enhanced stakeholder collaboration with the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), Regional Security Councils (REGSEC), Water Resources Commission (WRC), and recently, the commissioned Blue Water Guards to map out and protect raw water sources and their catchments and all.

I want to know from the Hon Minister that the costs for the items one and two, is it coming from Ghana Water Limited or it is being funded by Government of Ghana (GoG) through his Ministry? In other words, the emergency dredging of intake points, as well as the construction and upgrading of the treatment facilities.

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, it is coming from the Internally Generated Funds (IGF) of Ghana Water Limited.

The Speaker: Well, I may give you one last supplementary question.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, may I know from the Hon Minister the extent to which this IGF can sufficiently cater for these major works. This is because in his Answer, he indicated, respectfully, that as a result of the effect of *galamsey* on the cost of

treatment, revenues of Ghana Water are affected. Obviously, if their revenues are affected, there would be nothing really. So, if he says that all of these: the sensitisation programme, the construction and the upgrading of treatment facilities, and he has listed them, and that there is expansion at the Sekondi Takoradi to handle relatively higher turbidity levels above 2,000 Nephelometric Turbidity Unit (NTU). That is quite huge.

I want to know from the Minister, to what extent will IGF be sufficient and if it would not be, is he making plans to ensure that GoG provides support in the Mid-Year Review to enable him handle this situation?

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, we are aware that the IGF, on its own, cannot really work on all the things that I mentioned. So, we are looking at other sources to implement that.

Mr John Darko: Mr Speaker, in the Answer of the Minister, as advertised, I see that he did not show how the fight of Government against *galamsey*, if any, is impacting on the raw water intake. Is this because he does not see any concerted effort from Government in fighting against *galamsey* that is why he did not mention it as one of the ways by which this problem can be solved to this House?

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, I thought my Question was not really to Answer about *galamsey*. I know the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources is doing a lot about *galamsey*, so, I am sure that when

this is directed to him, he will be able to answer it very well.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Thank you, Mr Speaker—*[Interruption]*— Why, are you now?

The Speaker: He wants to ask a supplementary question.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, please, do I?

The Speaker: Yes, please, go on.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, page 14 of the Order Paper has captured the Answer of the Hon Minister and I quote:

“To put the cost implications into perspective, the price of polymers is four times as much as the price of traditional coagulants such as aluminium sulphate used for water treatment in areas where the water source has not been polluted as a result of illegal or *galamsey* activities”

Mr Speaker, my question to the Hon Minister is that can he give us the exact cost that is involved.

The Speaker: Yes, Minister, will you be able to give us the exact cost that is involved?

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, I can get the exact cost and send it to the honourable House.

Mr Ayariga: So, Speaker, I would like to find out from the Minister, in his Answer, he reports of alarming turbidity

levels in the major rivers such as Pra, Birim, Densu, Anum...

4.06 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Minister; in his Answer, he reports of alarming turbidity levels in the major rivers such as Pra, Birim, Densu, Anum, Oda, Ankobra, Tano, Offin, and the Black Volta, and then he talks about the siltation of the Pra River. So, these high turbidity levels and the siltation that has taken place, did it just happen or he met the situation like that when he got there as a Minister?

The Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Mr Adjei: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, those are figures that I got when I assumed office.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, there is now an empty stable.

The Speaker: Sorry?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I am saying that the stable is now empty. Those I was seeking to arrest have bolted. So, my intervention is now otiose; so, I rest my case.

The Speaker: I am not sure you listened.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I did. Very much so.

The Speaker: You listened to the question, but I am not sure you listened to the answer.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: It was the question I wanted to arrest, but you said I should resume my seat and wait. But at this point, once he has come in and dealt with it, it is all right.

The Speaker: I find it difficult that a Member will want to arrest a question that is being asked by another Member. It is not possible. He has not been able—Unless you decide not to. If you waive your right, or if you concede, the Speaker cannot do anything. But no Member can arrest a question being asked by another Member. That is not possible.

Yes, Majority Leader, you were on your feet.

You would realise that the Minister did not answer your question.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, that is why I want to repeat it. Maybe he did not—*[Interruption]*—Mr Speaker, the Minister, in his answer, said that Ghana Water Limited has reported alarming turbidity levels in the aforementioned water bodies and these are Pra, Birim, Densu, Anum, Oda, Ankobra, Tano, Offin, Black Volta, and a few others. And that as a result of the activities of illegal mining, there has been siltation of the Pra River. And I asked him whether these conditions that the Ghana Water Limited reported just happened or they

gave him a report about the conditions there when he was appointed to the Ministry; whether those are the conditions he met when he went to the Ministry. That was the question that I asked.

In any case, I have five questions. I have five, unlike him who has three as supplementary questions in addition to his original Question. I, as the Leader asking supplementary questions, have five. I can ask him the same question five times and it is my right. It is there; I can ask him the same question five times. I can turn it upside down; I can turn it sideways, but I can ask five of them.

So, Mr Speaker, did the Minister meet those conditions when he went to the Ministry or did they just developed in the last five months? That is my question.

The Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, those were what I met when I resumed office as a Minister.

The Speaker: Minister, they said they cannot hear you.

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, those were the figures that I received when I got to office as a Minister.

The Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: So, for the avoidance of doubt, the high turbidity levels and the high siltation levels have been the result of illegal mining for the past eight years and that was what the Minister met when

he went there. For the avoidance of doubt.

The Speaker: Majority Leader, you definitely know that you are completely out of order.

Hon Members, we move to the next Question.

You have a supplementary question?

Hon Members, I am being very magnanimous because of the nature of the subject matter: water; potable water. That is why, if not, I would not have allowed you, but I will allow you if you have any serious supplementary question; it must be a serious one.
[Laughter]

Please, let us move on to the next Question numbered 108. It stands in the name of the Hon Member of Parliament for Atwima Mponua, Hon Seth Osei-Akoto.

Hon Member, you may please ask your Question now.

The First Deputy Speaker to take the chair.

Resumption of Work of the 27 Abandoned Toilet Facilities in 27 Communities in the Atwima Mponua Constituency

Mr Seth Osei-Akoto (NPP — Atwima Mponua): Thank you, Mr Speaker for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water

Resources when work will resume on the 27 abandoned toilet facilities located in 27 different communities within the Atwima Mponua Constituency initiated by Ghana First Company Limited.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Adjei: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I think that Question is supposed to be directed to the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs because it has something to do with 27 abandoned toilet facilities. That does not fall under my sector.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Member, please let me hear from you.

Mr Osei-Akoto: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Respectfully, may I kindly request that this Question be directed to the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes.

4.16 p.m.

Hon Members, I see that Members are not following the correct procedure in submission of Questions. Definitely, a lot of you are first-timers, and if you have

difficulty in structuring your Questions, the technical Clerks are there to assist you. On the other hand, you can approach your Leaders to assist you, and also pass them through the Leaders.

I have assigned the First Deputy Speaker to handle the issue of Questions and admission of Statements. The Second Deputy Speaker is handling Requests of Absence. I handle the others administratively. It is a lot of work. So, please, kindly assist them.

Particularly, the Questions are becoming too many and I do not think that there is enough time to scrutinise them properly to make sure that they conform to the Rules of the House. So, please, assist my colleagues, Deputy Speakers, to be able to admit the Questions well. Some of these Questions are not well captured. But once they appear here, it is not for The Speaker to be guillotining Questions. It is for us to create space for you to air your views once they are within the Rules. You are not representing yourselves; you are representing millions of people in the country. That is why I have become so gracious in giving you the opportunity to do what you are doing. It is not a waste of time. It is for you to make sure that the people outside there feel that you are representing them effectively.

Please, Mr First Deputy Speaker may take the Chair.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, there is a very weighty matter, and I was hoping that you would be in the Chair—

The Speaker: A weighty matter?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Yes, that is so. Mr Speaker, I am not saying that all the other matters that we have discussed are not weighty. But ordinarily, during Statement time, I was going to ask for your leave to raise an issue of urgent public importance.

Mr Speaker, it occurred during your absence as The Speaker. On the 7th of July, 2025, we were saddened by the loss of one of our Colleagues, and it broke in the news. We all read it in the news. But the Hon Minority Leader came to the House and asked to make a Statement pursuant to Order 92, I recall. When Mr Speaker granted him audience, he announced to this House, the passing of one of our Colleagues, the Hon Member of Parliament for Akwatia, the late Hon Ernest Kumi.

Mr Speaker, he reported to this House the passing of our Colleague, and hence, it became an official communication that our Colleague had passed. So, that decision of my Colleague, the Hon Minority Leader, to communicate to this House the passing of our Colleague has raised some very serious constitutional matters. As Majority Leader, I have received a series of communications from people who are saying that in Article 112 (5) of our Constitution, where it says, and with your permission, I quote:

“Whenever a vacancy occurs in Parliament, the Clerk to Parliament shall notify the Electoral Commission in writing within seven days after becoming aware that the vacancy has occurred; and a by-election shall be held within 30 days after the vacancy occurred...”

So, Mr Speaker, having officially informed this House as the Leader of that Caucus, that our Colleague passed, unfortunately, it has become the official communication to this House and notification of the occurrence of a vacancy. So, people are asking if the Clerk, within seven days communicated to the Electoral Commission the passing of our Colleague and the occurrence of a vacancy? If that is the case, are they to expect a by-election 30 days following the passing of our Colleague?

Mr Speaker, before the communication, there was some discussion of this matter, our Colleague in his communication to the House said that it was without prejudice to Article 112, and the constitutional implications on the passing of a Colleague, but it has become a matter of public concern. I have received a series of requests for information regarding what we are doing as a House.

Mr Speaker, I feel that I should raise it before you, and for you to take a decision on what the direction should be. Are we to treat the communication from the Leader of the Minority Caucus to this House, that our Colleague belonging to

his Side is no more; as a communication that the seat has become vacant?

Mr Speaker, vacancy occurs when the person passes, and there is no doubt about the passing. This House, ordinarily in the past, never discusses the matter until there was an official communication by The Speaker. But on this occasion, we took the step of formally communicating to this House, and we all expressed our messages of condolences. It has become part of the official record that this House has become seized with the information that our Colleague has passed. Therefore, there is a vacancy. Should this House be communicating within the seven days? Should there be a by-election within the 30 days of the occurrence of the event? These are matters that I think, as The Speaker, you need to give some direction, and I thought to raise it while you are in the seat so that you will take a decision on the matter.

So, if I arrested your decision to let the First Deputy Speaker take the seat, it is because of this important constitutional matter that I think you should give us some indications on how to proceed.

Thank you Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Partick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, the Leader of the House in his submissions referred to Standing Order 92 and Article 112(5). Orders 92, with your kind permission, I read:

“Ceremonial speech

A ceremonial speech may be permitted and the speech shall be confined to commemorating a special event, eulogising a renowned personality or a deceased distinguished person.”

4.26 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the practice of this House, as we have all come to understand and appreciate, is that such ceremonial speeches are confined to situations like, a national day, celebrating a very important personality like a former president, former first lady and such other important personalities. When it comes to a Member of Parliament passing, sadly, in this case, the Speaker is informed, a Statement is admitted, a speech is made on the Floor, Members are given the opportunity to contribute to the person of the said Member and it is admitted.

Mr Speaker, if we read Article 112(5), it deals with a situation where a vacancy has occurred and the Clerk to Parliament, and with your kind permission, I read again:

“Whenever a vacancy occurs in Parliament, the Clerk of Parliament shall notify the Electoral Commission...”.

Mr Speaker, the Clerk to Parliament, fortunately, is here. Has he been notified officially of the passing of the Member of Parliament for Akwatia? Has he written to the Electoral Commission with the kind permission of the Speaker? I believe sincerely it has not happened.

What I believe the Minority Leader did was just an information to the House on the passing of a Colleague, which is not within the ambit of Standing Orders 92 and Article 112(5). That is my submission to you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I do not want to permit further discussion on this matter. You have read the Article and this House spent some time in looking at that Article. Government itself did and there was an amendment to that Article. It is all in your Constitution; now, the original Article 112(5) says,

“Whenever a vacancy occurs in Parliament, the Clerk to Parliament shall notify the Electoral Commission in writing within seven days after the vacancy occurred, and a by-election shall be held within 30 days after the vacancy occurred.”

Now, when does a vacancy occur? We have been given a number of them, including death. When do you consider a person to have died? Who certifies that this person has died? Recently, somebody I know collapsed in his room and, for four days, he was unconscious. Even though he was sent to the hospital, he was just lying there unconscious. On the fourth day, he woke up and realised he was in the hospital. Now, some people would have taken it that the day he collapsed and he was unconscious and motionless, he would be considered as dead and may be buried before he could get up on the fourth day. So, there must be an authority to say that the person has died and that is why the medical profession developed the word

“clinically dead”. With that one, they are sure you are no more.

Traditionally, there is an authority that has to come out to say that the person is dead. You know our royals and the process they pass through. You know the processes we pass through in our families. There is not any person outside anywhere that can tell you that this person is dead. It has happened to many and they have always risen up. In fact, they do not even die, but some people say that the person is dead.

I recall—This one is true, but it is on the lighter side and I know you will laugh. Somebody who was interested in another man’s wife declared that the man was dead. They organised the man’s funeral and that permitted him to marry the man’s wife. After a few weeks, the man showed up. Now, he was advised in his own interest that, once the funeral had been organised you are dead, if he does not disappear, they will kill him—*[Laughter]*—This is a true story. I can mention names. So, the person has to do what? He has to vamoose. So, please, let us continue that way.

We always want the proper authority to inform the House of the death of a colleague Member of Parliament before we take action. We do not want to fall into these kinds of traps. Now, this matter was discussed by this House and that led to an amendment, which is in the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana (Amendment) Act 1996, (Act 527) and that is Section 3 of that Act and I want to read it:

Article 112 of the Constitution is amended by the repeal of clause (5) and the insertion of the following—

“(5) Whenever a vacancy occurs in Parliament, the Clerk of Parliament shall notify the Electoral Commission in writing within seven days after becoming aware that the vacancy has occurred; and a by-election shall be held within thirty days after the vacancy occurred except that where the vacancy occurred through the death of member, the by-election shall be held within sixty days after the occurrence of the vacancy”

Now, clearly from the original Article 112, the person who is to inform the Electoral Commission is the Clerk. The Clerk does not just get up, listen to news or any Member and write a letter to the Electoral Commission that a Member is no more. No, we are officially informed with evidence that the person is no more. Based on that, the Speaker would then direct the Clerk to issue the letter to the Electoral Commission.

4.36 p.m.

The Clerk to Parliament acts as an administrator. The Clerk to Parliament does not control Members of Parliament. He is the head of the administration of the Parliamentary Service. He is not the head of Members of Parliament. It is the Speaker who presides over you, so he can direct the Clerk to Parliament that this is what has happened to one of my

Members. The Clerk to Parliament cannot do that.

To the best of my knowledge, no such communication has been issued. The Clerk to Parliament has not been given any such authority to do so. Please, I think the reference to the Standing Orders, the Standing Orders from the heading says “Ceremonial Speech”, ceremonial. The death of a Member cannot be a ceremonial speech at all. So, I am sure the Minority Leader erred in coming to do what he did. That is not to be continued.

We should discontinue it because the likelihood of any Member coming in and making a Statement on somebody he does not like perishing is great. And so, so far as the Electoral Commission (EC) is concerned, unless they have evidence of a letter from the Clerk to Parliament communicating to them, because when they get the letter from the Clerk to Parliament, they will be acting constitutionally if they decide to process for any by-election. That is the position. I think that it was not right and it should not be repeated.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the guidance you have given, but there is a twist to the facts. It is more complicated than that. After the Statement that was made in this House and our various responses on this Side, the following morning, the Leadership and some Members of Parliament, together with the Clerk to Parliament, then conveyed ourselves to the family

and this was carried on television and reported on radio. It was live reported on *Citi FM*.

At the residence of the deceased, we told them that we had heard and so, we were coming to confirm, led by our Clerk to Parliament. They received us and said they were confirming to us that, indeed, he had passed. Mr Speaker, the Clerk to Parliament was there and it was on television. It was carried live on radio and Ghanaians saw it and listened to it that the Minority, the Majority, and their Leadership, led by the Clerk to Parliament, had gone to the family to enquire whether, indeed, it is true that he had passed. And the family said, yes, indeed, he had passed.

Then we made all the commitments to help the family with the funeral and every other thing that mattered thereafter. So, Ghanaians saw everything. I am still saying that if we look at the constitutional provision, it says, whenever a vacancy occurs in Parliament, the Clerk to Parliament shall notify the Electoral Commission in writing within seven days after becoming aware—The Clerk to Parliament after becoming aware.

Mr Speaker, if Ghanaians ask the Clerk to Parliament, is he aware or not, can he say he is not aware? Because after being informed by the Leader of the Caucus, through a Statement in this House, the Clerk to Parliament himself followed up to the residence, met the family members of the deceased and asked them, and they confirmed to him

that the deceased has passed. This was on national television and radio.

Mr Speaker, can the Clerk to Parliament say that he is not yet aware? That is the dilemma that I am confronted with. These are the full facts. People are calling to ask me, “Ayariga, you are sitting there; you say you know the Constitution and this is happening under your nose. Have you brought it to the attention of the Speaker?”

At the meeting of the Business Committee, I drew the attention of the Minority Side and said, this is what has happened; I will raise it so that the Speaker will take a decision on the matter. But these are the facts. Is the Clerk to Parliament aware? Did he go to the residence to ascertain? Did they confirm to him? Now that he has become aware constructively, what is he doing?

The Speaker: Well, let me listen to the Minority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, when we heard of this issue, I think the whole Parliament was devastated and the next day, we met at Conclave. At Conclave, the decision was that we were not going to do any Business. We will just come and adjourn. However, upon further deliberation, the Leadership decided that we cannot also just keep quiet. So, at least, when we come, we should raise the matter and it is not going to be opened for comments. It is just for the two Leaders.

Mr Speaker, when I put out the information, I emphasised in my Statement a caveat that this does not amount to an official communication and that it is not as part of the processes to trigger any constitutional imperative. It was clear and *Hansard* bears me out.

The next day, the Clerk to Parliament and Leadership drove to the family house where we met the wife and some family members. What we told them was that the Head of this Assembly, being you, was not in the jurisdiction, and we had heard this. We want to come and find out from them and report back to you.

Mr Speaker, on record, the *okyeame* for the family, the linguist who spoke on behalf of the family, told us that, indeed, there was a situation like that. However, the gentleman being a royal, they were only in Accra to work, but they have to go back to the family and officially inform the family. After that, they would come and inform Parliament because being a royal, there is a need for a family member to lead to officially inform you.

Mr Speaker, our spokesperson, Leadership and the Clerk to Parliament nominated Hon Annoh-Dompreh to speak on our behalf. So, they asked us to nominate one from among us to be the liaison to give notice of when they are coming.

4.46 p.m.

So, we nominated Hon Collins Adomako-Mensah to be the one to liaise with them.

Mr Speaker, in fact, the Hon Minority Chief Whip, Mr Annoh-Dompreh, asked the Leader of the House whether there was anything to add. He said, whatever he said on our behalf is full and final. Mr Speaker, I do not understand the sudden twist where some constructive meaning is being given to this matter and that the Clerk-to-Parliament is being pushed into a tight corner. You have spoken to us about our tradition. You have spoken to us about the processes that lead to this communication and even the amendment to Article 112(5), which you read aloud and *in extenso*. Article 112(5), as amended in 1996, is here.

Mr Speaker read it aloud and *in extenso*. So, it is not true and it is not the case that the Clerk-to-Parliament went there on his own. Based on what Leadership discussed with him is what led all of us to go and the family was clear that the gentleman is a royal and by tradition, they cannot just get up—And there is no royal family member in Accra; they are all in the village.

So, Mr Speaker, I would want to beg of the respected Leader of the House. If he says people are calling him and asking what he is doing, he is a constitutionalist and all, I will plead with him. This is a very sad situation; we are all struck by this. It is somebody's life. We do not know tomorrow. Let us not create the impression that somebody is in a rush for the purpose of political convenience.

Mr Speaker has given us a direction. Mr Speaker has guided us. Let us contact the family and I am sure that the family would equally contact us. This is not the

first time a situation like this has occurred. And let us appreciate the sensitivity around this and not create the impression that we are so insensitive and we want to hurriedly do something to fill the vacancy. So, Mr Speaker, that is it.

To conclude, Mr Speaker, I did not come here to make a ceremonial speech. Mr Speaker, this is a House of record—Because you had commented that if I did so then I was wrong. No, Mr Speaker, I was very guided. I am still a student of parliamentary jurisprudence. I am careful. I know I can make mistakes but I was careful which of the rules to come under and we all discussed it. So, I did not come to make a ceremonial speech. No. I got up, Mr Speaker, to crave the indulgence of the Chair to inform and for us to discuss the matter.

So, Mr Speaker, that is all I would want to add.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please, the Speaker is a presiding officer. The Speaker is not a judge. If I have to operate as a judge, there are so many questions that will have to be answered before you can take a well-considered decision on this matter. But there are three essential things you have to look at when you read that clause of the Article because it is in the context: one, vacancy occurring; two, when; three, time limits given to the Clerk-to-Parliament.

These are very essential. It is not just about a Member dying but when did the Member die? Because the time starts running from that day, not when the Clerk-to-Parliament informs the

Electoral Commission in writing; no. So, those three things are very essential in processing this matter. So, even for you going, there is nothing wrong with it because you have heard, and even traditionally, that is what we do. So, there is nothing wrong with you going there to find out whether what you have heard is really true. But that is not sufficient basis for you to be saying that a vacancy has occurred.

There must be further evidence because those people you met might turn out not to be the family or head of family or linguist under cross-examination. So, that is sufficient for you to show concern that a Colleague suddenly has fallen. It is a shock so you move to try and find out; there is nothing wrong with that one. But you will want some authority, some evidence and do not forget the Constitution talks about doing so in writing. The writing will state that the person is no more and it occurred on this date. Then the Electoral Commission can start counting from that date. In the case of death, within 60 days, there must be a by-election. The Clerk-to-Parliament is given to act within seven days. So, what you have done is right by following up because it is not only news.

A Leader of the House, in the person of the Minority Leader, has also given notice. So, the Clerk cannot pretend not to have heard. So, you have to follow up. But to act, the Clerk will need more than just that because in writing to the Electoral Commission, the Clerk will have to state categorically that the death occurred on this date and if possible, the time and then the Electoral Commission

will start calculating from that date. So, if we have not yet received, in writing, that letter, the Clerk, by not communicating, has not done anything wrong because there is not sufficient basis for the Clerk to write and say that a Statement was made on this date on the Floor, then he followed up to the family, it was confirmed and he relies on that. Later on, some other family members can come out—It has happened in this country a number of times where people have come out to contest the earlier information. So, we still need some evidence to rely on for the Clerk to write.

But as I told you, the Clerk just does not proceed to act and the position of the Speaker is always here in the House. The person might be outside the jurisdiction. But for the Speaker, it is a creation of the Constitution and it is always here. That is why the Speaker have at least two deputies. Even if I am not here and they get in touch with me, I give the necessary authority to act on my behalf. That is on the administration.

4.56 p.m.

But in presiding, they do not need that authority. Once I have left, they can preside. But when it comes to administration, they will need the authority because of the law, not only the Constitution but the Constitutive Act of Parliament itself has stated it clearly.

So, this is the guidance I can give the House.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, when we arrived at the residence of the deceased, and we asked, they provided the Clerk with details of the incident, the hospital where the incident occurred and the time when the incident occurred. So, Mr Speaker, we must pay attention to the language of our Constitution and what it says.

I am saddened by an attempt by my Colleague, the Minority Leader, to create an impression that I am being insensitive and that there is a sudden haste to rush and have a by-election, *et cetera*. Mr Speaker, I really have no interest beyond my fidelity to the Constitution and the language of the Constitution. When the Constitution says, “when the Clerk becomes aware”, and I have gone with the Clerk to the family house, and the family has informed both myself and the Clerk, and informed the Clerk of the hospital and the time—They informed him that the doctors there confirmed—and I was sitting there with him.

Mr Speaker, if after all these facts occurring on national television—we can go for the tapes and the records, where they informed myself, the Clerk, the Minority Leader, and about 35 other Members of Parliament. They told us the hospital, the time, and the confirmation by the doctors, it is up to the Clerk to follow up to the hospital and get the certification, because he has been told, so that he can do what he is constitutionally obliged to do.

For the records, no one is being insensitive here. For the records, no one is in a haste. Indeed, Mr Speaker, I have

seen posters put out by the NPP announcing the wife of the deceased as their parliamentary candidate in the by-election when we have not yet even performed the funeral of the deceased. Who is being insensitive here? —
[*Interruption*]—

Mr Speaker, the Constitution is clear in terms of the language, and that is why I am raising it.

[*Interruption*]

The Speaker: Hon Members!

Enough is enough. We are getting into some other very troubling areas. So, please, I told you what I did—
[*Interruption*]—

Hon Member! Hon Members! Please.

You are just talking about yourselves; you should at least be very sensitive to yourselves. You are talking about yourselves. Please, hmm!

Hon Members, let us leave it at this stage, and then the Leadership can discuss this using the usual channels of communication. The proper thing will be done and definitely—It is a democratic State so we will go through what the Law says we should do.

I want to plead with Members that as I leave the Chair, extend the same cooperation to the Deputy Speakers that will preside. Whatever I do when I leave the Chair, I always have an eye on what is happening on the Floor of Parliament. So, I do not want the current orderly

situation to deteriorate into anything. Let us do the Business of the day.

We are getting to the end of this Meeting, and what I gathered since I arrived last night is that we have a lot more Business to do. So let us end well, and definitely we are all shocked by the demise of our Colleague, but we are just trying to do the proper thing and it could be any of us.

I recall one Member only spent, I think, three months in Parliament. I think that the Hon Minister for the Interior could correct me on whether it was more than three months. I see he is not paying attention—[*Laughter*]—I do not know whether it was three months.

Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka: Mr Speaker he did thirty-nine days.

The Speaker: He was a doctor, but he only spent 39 days here, and he died suddenly. So, we have always had these shocks. This is not the first time. And what I am just experiencing, I experienced it at that time too. These same exchanges took place and that was what gave the public the impression that you do not matter. You do not even respect yourselves. So immediately it happens nobody cares about the dead. They are looking at who is going to replace the dead. And I recall at Fomena, I made a Statement—Because when I went to that funeral, they were wearing the T-shirts of the candidates. And I told them that in the unlikely event that I am no more a Member of Parliament, anybody who comes to my funeral with

a T-shirt of another person will not go back—[*Laughter*—I remember that very well. God being on my side, I am still alive. So please, take this seriously and let us do the proper thing. We will sit together, and do what is right. So, the Electoral Commission will properly be informed.

5.06p.m.

I thank you so much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker to take the Chair.

Hon Members, it is Question Time and we would continue with the Questions.

5.07 p.m. — [MR FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER IN THE CHAIR]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I regret to say that our Side feels that the issues that have been brought on this Floor appear to be very insensitive to us; therefore, we are withdrawing from the proceedings of today.

[5.09 p.m. – Members of the Minority walked out of the Chamber.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Kwame Agbodza?

Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza: Mr Speaker, what the respected Minority Leader did is in total disrespect to the comments made by the Speaker before leaving the Chair for you.

The Speaker admonished all of us to drop the issues and continue with the Business of today. Immediately, the Speaker left, our Colleagues on the other Side decided to do the opposite of what the Speaker said. That is very regrettable. That is very disrespectful to the Speaker and that must be put on record.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, can we make progress?

Hon Members, we will take the Question numbered 182, standing in the name of Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie, Member of Parliament for Odododiodioo.

Consistent Access to Potable Water for Households in Odododiodioo

Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (NDC — Odododiodioo): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources what concrete steps the Ministry is taking to ensure consistent access to potable water for households in Odododiodioo, particularly, in Old Fadama where water shortages have persisted for over six years.

Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources (Mr Kenneth Gilbert Adjei): Mr Speaker, customers of Ghana Water Limited (GWL) in the Odododiodioo Constituency receive potable water from the Weija Water Treatment Plant. To enhance water supply to the western part of Accra, GWL utilised its internally generated

funds (IGF) between December 2024 and May 2025 to replace all four pumps at its intake facility, ensuring adequate abstraction for treatment and distribution. All four pumps have now been successfully replaced and are fully operational, resulting in a substantial improvement in water supply across the western Greater Accra Metropolitan Area (GAMA), including Old Fadama.

Mr Speaker, the Old Fadama area is supplied with potable water through a 500mm diameter steel pipeline from Weija. According to GWL and Water Demand Management Plan, water is delivered to Old Fadama from Monday through Friday. However, the substantial increase in population and accelerated urban development have created challenges in consistently and effectively providing water to some of the higher-altitude areas of the enclaves. It should be emphasised that Old Fadama does not face a general water crisis. Any existing water-related issues are specific in nature and this will be identified, investigated and addressed as required.

Mr Speaker, as part of a long-term strategy, the Weija Rehabilitation and Expansion Project is being considered for implementation to enhance water supply to the western part of Accra, including Old Fadama. Upon completion, the project is projected to increase water production by 100,000m³ per day (22.22 million Gallons per Day), thereby addressing the water demand of the area up to the year 2045. The Ministry, in collaboration with GWL, is actively engaging with investors who have shown interest in supporting the

development of this project, with potential financing opportunities from donor partners currently under consideration.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary?

Mr Ashie: No, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I am grateful and I will follow up physically to ensure that the Response I have got actually reflects in the lives of the people of Odododiodioo.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move to the Question numbered 183, also standing in the name of Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie, Member of Parliament for Odododiodioo.

Mr Ayariga: — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, well, since you have already asked him, after he has asked the Question, I request for a variation of the order of Business, so that we take some Motions that have been hanging for several weeks.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Steps to Upgrade the Drainage Systems in Odododiodioo

Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (NDC — Odododiodioo): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources steps the Ministry is taking to upgrade drainage systems in

Ododiodioo to mitigate perennial flooding, particularly in low-lying areas such as Agboglobhie township.

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources acknowledges the significant flood risks faced by the residents in the Ododiodioo Constituency due to its topographic vulnerability, siltation and solid waste accumulation and dense informal development patterns. We recognise that these issues continue to threaten lives, public health, and economic activities in settlements such as Agboglobhie, James Town, and the Korle Lagoon precincts.

Mr Speaker, as part of the proactive efforts by the Government aimed at addressing the perennial flooding in the Greater Accra Region, the Ododiodioo Constituency is included in the Greater Accra Resilient and Integrated Development (GARID) Project, currently being implemented with funding support from the World Bank. The GARID project targets the Odaw Drainage Basin and includes 17 participating Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs), including the Accra Metropolitan Assembly (AMA) which has oversight or jurisdiction over Ododiodioo.

Mr Speaker, under the GARID Project, the performance-based dredging contract has been ongoing since February 2024 covering the dredging of the Odaw Basin, spanning the Caprice section all the way to the Korle Lagoon outfall. The contractor has undertaken two cycles of dredging activities at the

Agboglobhie section up to the Korle Lagoon.

Mr Speaker, in the process, the contractor has constructed a single-cell culvert behind Sewerage Systems which was completed in 3rd April, 2025. Presently, the dredging contractor is working from Avenor towards the outfall to the sea. It is anticipated that the contractor will reach the Agboglobhie section in September to ensure a full cycle of dredging from Caprice to the sea for 2025.

Mr Speaker, under the 2023 and 2024 GARID Operation and Maintenance (O&M) Grants, the Accra Metropolitan Assembly (AMA), which has jurisdiction over Ododiodioo, was supported to carry out desilting works on U-drains and secondary stormwater drains in high-risk locations. These interventions covered parts of Munkose, Kwakwalonite Street, Palace Street, Otublohum Street, St Mary's Senior High School, Bubuashie, Guggisberg Avenue Road, Awudome, Akuyea Street, Agbon Boi Street, Nyemi Gnor, Nii Teiko Din Street and Asafoatse Adja Street, among others.

5.16 p.m.

These desilting efforts restored partial flow capacity, cleared blockages caused by silt and solid waste, and provided temporary relief in flood-prone zones during recent rainfall events.

Mr Speaker, in addition to these maintenance efforts, the Ghana Hydrological Authority (HYDRO) is

working with AMA under the GARID framework to identify priority drainage channels within the constituency for engineering redesign. These will include detailed assessments of existing drainage infrastructure and structural improvements which will address bottlenecks with appropriate concrete lining, culvert expansion, and inlet/outlet upgrades.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry is also integrating climate-resilient and nature-based drainage solutions into medium to long-term plans for flood-prone coastal zones, including Ododiodioo. Furthermore, public education campaigns and local by-law enforcement will be intensified through the AMA-GARID partnership to prevent waste dumping into drains, which remains a key contributor to flooding in Agboglobhie.

Mr Speaker, recognising the contribution of poor solid waste management to flooding events, the GARID project has undertaken several waste clearing exercises to reduce the risk of solid waste ending up in the drains. In particular, the following activities have been undertaken:

a. Timber market area –

- i. Formed and trained a local Community Sanitation Committee and equipped them with PPEs and small tools,
- ii. The Sanitation committee has undertaken five

community clean up exercises

iii. Evacuation of refuse (1,266 cubic meters)

b. Agboglobhie area

i. Formed and trained a local Community Sanitation Committee and equipped them with PPEs and small tools,

ii. The Sanitation committee has undertaken eight community clean up exercises

iii. Evacuation of refuse (2,527 cubic meters)

c. Adedenkpo area

i. Evacuation of refuse (5,588 cubic meters)

d. Jamestown About six community clean-up exercises

Mr Speaker, I wish to assure the Hon Member and the good people of Ododiodioo that the Ministry and HYDRO remain committed to resolving the long-standing flooding problems in the constituency. The integrated interventions under GARID, combined with the engineering expertise of HYDRO, and the enforcement mandate of AMA will provide a sustainable and resilient solution to protect lives, assets,

and livelihoods in the Agbogloboshie township and surrounding areas.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Ashie: Mr Speaker, the good people of Agbogloboshie, led by the Assembly Member, Hon Ashie Kotey, who happens to be a cousin, are very grateful. I will personally follow up to ensure that they get what is due them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will then move to the Question numbered 198 which stands in the name of Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey, Hon Member of Parliament for Yilo Krobo.

Completion of Some Water Extension Projects in Yilo Krobo

Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (NDC—Yilo Krobo): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources when work will resume and be completed on the water extension project from Huhunya - Boti - Agogo - Opesika - Nsutapong - Akpo - Akpamu in the Yilo Krobo Municipality, which has halted since January 2025.

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, Ghana Water Limited (GWL) has undertaken pipeline extension works in selected areas of the Yilo Krobo Constituency, funded by its Internally Generated Funds (IGF). The pipeline installation from Huhunya to Boti has been completed and water supply is now accessible to communities

situated along the Huhunya–Akaa corridor.

Communities along the corridor from Akaa to Boti have access to water, and Ghana Water Limited will be able to undertake household water connections once requests are received from prospective households. Pipeline construction has begun between Boti and Osuboi No. 1 & No. 2, but commissioning of the pipeline is pending until the contractor completes the necessary remedial works.

Mr Speaker, communities including Opesika, Nsutapong, Akpo, and Akpamu do not yet have pipeline infrastructure, as the extension works are proceeding in phases. Pipeline construction in these areas will be undertaken as soon as the requisite funds are secured to enhance the supply of potable water to the aforementioned communities.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Dr Nyakotey: Mr Speaker, I wish to thank the Hon Minister for his Response. I have no further questions for him. I will engage him privately to make progress on the issues.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we will then move to the Question numbered 269 which stands in the name of Mr Nana Osei-Adjei, Hon Member for New Juaben North.

Hon Members, the Member is not here to ask the Question and nobody is authorised by the Member to ask the Question. Accordingly, the Answer would be printed and communicated to the Hon Member.

Resumption of Relocation and Repair Works on GWL Pipelines between Jumapo and Suhyen.

Mr Nana Osei-Adjei (NPP — New Juaben North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources when the relocation and repair works on existing Ghana Water Limited (GWL) pipelines between Jumapo and Suhyen will resume and be completed for the road construction to commence.

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, the road works under discussion commenced in 2024 by Messrs Volta Impex under the supervision of the Department of Feeder Roads (DFR) office in the Eastern Region. As part of the road construction project, all existing utilities were to be relocated to make way for the successful execution of the road project. However, the road contractor commenced works on the Jumapo–Suhyen stretch without coordinating with GWL for the prior relocation of existing pipelines, which is the standard practice. As a result of the lack of coordination on the part of the road contractor, 3km of GWL's 7 inches' diameter and 8 inches diameter transmission pipelines were damaged.

Mr Speaker, it is important to emphasise that the relocation of utility infrastructure, including water pipelines,

was to have been undertaken before the commencement of road construction and funding for such relocation was to be borne by the road project in accordance with standard infrastructure project procedures.

Mr Speaker, following the pipeline damage by the road contractor, GWL submitted an estimate of GH¢3,097,931.42 as the cost of the water pipeline relocation works to the contractor through the Eastern Regional Director for the Department of Feeder Roads on 20th June, 2024. However, payment has not been made by the road contractor and as such, GWL has not been able to undertake the necessary relocation works. This situation has deprived the supply area of potable water and exposed the beneficiary communities and GWL to a public health crisis and regulatory sanctions, respectively.

Mr Speaker, two possible courses of action are currently being considered by the Ministry and GWL to resolve the impasse:

1. The preferred option will be for the contractor to honour his obligation by providing the necessary funds for the relocation works, as originally required under the terms of project execution.
2. Alternatively, GWL may proceed to fund the relocation works from its constrained internally generated resources, with the clear understanding that the contractor

will be required to fully reimburse GWL.

Mr Speaker, I wish to assure this honourable House and the good people of New Juaben North that the Ministry is committed to ensuring both the protection of critical water infrastructure and the timely delivery of road infrastructure. To this end, urgent engagements are ongoing between the Ministry, GWL, the contractor, and the supervising road agency to reach a resolution that will allow the relocation to be executed without further delay.

[Published by order of Mr Speaker]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, this brings us to your last Question. We thank you very much for attending upon the House to respond to Questions. You are hereby discharged.
[Hear! Hear!]

Hon Members, let us move to Question numbered 135, scheduled for the Minister for Energy and Green Transition.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for the Interior is here. He has a Regulation that he wants to just lay, so I am pleading if we can just—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us turn to the Order Paper *Addendum*. At the Commencement of Public Business, we would take Presentation of Instruments.

INSTRUMENT

Immigration Service (Amendment)
Regulations, 2025.

*Laid by the Minister for the Interior
(Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka).
Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary
Legislation.*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move back to Questions. The first one, Question numbered 135, stands in the name of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey, Hon Member of Parliament for Keta.

Ing Surv Maxwell Kwame Lukotor: Mr Speaker, I rise under Order 88(3), and I have the authority of the questioner to do so. I seek your—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, leave is hereby granted.

Ing Surv Lukotor: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

MINISTRY OF ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSITION

Measures to Address Power Generation Capacity to Reduce the Frequency of Power Outages.

**Ing Surv Maxwell Kwame Lukotor
on behalf of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli
Gakpey (NDC — Keta):** Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition what measures are

being taken to address the issue of power generation capacity and efforts aimed at reducing the frequency in power outages and how the Ministry is planning to resolve the inefficiency of the transmission and distribution networks.

5.26 p.m.

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor) (MP): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, to address power generation capacity issues and reduce the frequency of power outages, the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition, in collaboration with the relevant agencies, such as the Minister for Roads and Highways, who has been of immense support to me in the discharge of my duties, is implementing the following interventions:

- i. Ensuring that thermal and hydro power plants are properly maintained (Mandatory maintenance) to continue operating and generating power.
- ii. Repowering and refurbishment of broken-down plants such as the 132MW Takoradi Thermal (T3) power plant to restore their availability and efficiency.
- iii. Installation of additional capacities, for instance, installation of the Ameri, AKSA, CENIT plants at the Anwomaso Generating Station.

iv. Additional supply of gas from Nigeria (N-Gas) for power generation.

v. Gas supplied from ENI has increased from 245-270mmscf.

vi. Procurement of liquid fuels to augment power generation when there is inadequate supply of gas.

1. The following interventions are being implementing to resolve inefficiencies in the transmission and distribution networks:

- i. Obsolete distribution lines and transformers are being replaced by the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG) and Northern Electricity Distribution Company (NEDCo) to minimize technical faults and reduce outages.
- ii. There are also focused investments to reduce commercial and technical losses, including the World Bank's 800,000-meter replacement programme to improve billing and collection.
- iii. 330kV Eastern Corridor network, Accra-Kumasi and Ghana-Cote d'Ivoire interconnection are some of the earmarked transmission

projects to improve grid resilience.

We have secured funding now and as we get the funding, we hope that we would have consistent supply of fuel particularly liquid fuels. We are also working with ECG to ensure that they adhere to the Cash Waterfall Mechanism. They are currently operating a single treasury account with the GCB Bank where all these funds are accounted for.

The ECG has also constituted a four-gang team to attend to outages. I am happy to note that for four months, continuously, we have had stable supply of power. We have stabilised the system and now exporting power to all our neighbouring countries.

Mr Speaker, these are some of the measures that we have put in place in order to ensure that we continue to have stable, reliable, and uninterrupted supply of power.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Minister.

Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Ing Surv Lukutor: Mr Speaker, no, just to be grateful to the Minister and the Government for the good work they are

doing and we hope that *dumsor* does not surface.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. The Question numbered 136 also standing in the name of Hon Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey.

Ing Surv Lukutor: Mr Speaker, I have the authority of the questioner to also do the same.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Go ahead.

Cost and Distribution of Electricity Metres

Ing Surv Maxwell Kwame Lukutor on behalf of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (NDC — Keta): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the total number of electricity meters procured during 2017-2024. How much it cost the state and distribution and whether they have been certified and calibrated by Ghana Standards Authority?

Mr John Abdulai Jinapor: Between the period 2017 – 2024, a total of 4,202,856 single phase and 22,600 three energy meters were procured at total costs of GHC 627,749,279.00 and US\$568,716,571.00, by the Ministry, ECG and NEDCo. The breakdown is indicated in the table below;

Item No.	Institution	Single Phase Meter	Three Phase Meter	Total Cost (GH¢)	Total Cost (US\$)
1	Ministry of Energy and Green Transition	412,979	22,600	376,668,308.24	0.00
2	ECG	2,976,145			520,969,585.00
3	NEDCo	813,732		251,080,970.55	47,746,985.68
	Total	4,202,856	22,600	627,749,279.00	568,716,571.00

Meter Distribution: The meters were distributed primarily for;

- a) Ministry of Energy and Green Transition - Self-Help Electrification Programme
- b) ECG/NEDCo - new service connections, extensions and replacements.

Meter Certification – Meter certifications were done through Factory Acceptance Testing (FAT) at meter manufacturer's laboratories. The FAT includes checks to ensure the testing equipment are calibrated. Additionally, ECG and Ghana Standards Authority do further test before deployment to the fields for installation.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary?

Ing Surv Lukutor: Mr Speaker, no supplementary but I just would thank the Minister for a good job done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member. Let us

move to the Question numbered 146 standing in the name of Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo, Member of Parliament for Oforikrom.

Hon Members, the Member in whose name the Question is standing is not available to ask the Question. May I ask that the Answer if published should be communicated to the Hon Member.

Imminent Shutdown of the Karpowership Power Plant

Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (NPP — Oforikrom): To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the measures the Ministry has implemented to avert the imminent shutdown of the Karpowership power plant.

Mr John Abdulai Jinapor: Since February 2025, on the Minister for Energy and Green Transition directive, ECG has been committed to fully implementing the provisions and allocations of the Cash Waterfall Mechanism (CWM). The CWM is a mechanism that guarantees that revenues collected by ECG are distributed to agencies and service providers along the electricity value chain in proportion to

the cost of providing the services. The ECG's compliance with the CWM has resulted in increased and predictable payments to Karpowership and the other beneficiaries along the electricity value chain. The MoEnGT is also liaising with the Ministry of Finance (MoF) for the release of funds to address legacy debts owed to Karpowership and the other companies.

In line with the above, the MoEnGT and MoF have recently met with the management of Karpowership on the effort to settle the arrears. Karpowership has since rescinded its decision to shut down production.

[Published by order of Mr Speaker]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Question numbered 213 standing in the name of Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah, Ahafo Ano South West. Is the Hon Member available to ask the Question? Hon Members, similarly the Hon Member is not available to ask the Question. The Answer published should be communicated to the Hon Member.

Current State of the China Water Electrification Project of Communities in the Ahafo Ano South West

Mr Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah (Ahafo Ano South West): To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the current state of the China Water electrification project in the underlisted communities within the Ahafo Ano South West Constituency: (i) Kofinslakrom (ii) Asikantia (iii) Dajanso

(iv) Afreseni (v) Kramokrom (vi) Kwasimarfo (vii) Asuogya (viii) Damiabra (ix) Nyamebekyere (x) Ohiapae (xi) Sunkwa (xii) Mpasaaso (xiii) Nyamekyere (xiv) Besease (xv) Yaahene (xvi) Nyameahyiraso (xvii) Awadua Fie.

Mr John Abdulai Jinapor: The communities namely, Kofinslakrom (Koonsiakrom), Asikantia, Dajanso, Afreseni, Kramokrom (Kunsu Kramokrom), Kwasimarfo (Akwasimarfo), Asuogya, Nyamebekyere, Ohiapae, Sunkwa, Mpasaaso (Mpasaaso No. 2), Mpasaaso Nyamebekyere, Besease, Yaahene, and Nyameahyiraso form part of the Ministry of energy and Green Transition's ongoing electrification project being executed by M/S China International Water and Electric Corporation (CWE).

Installation works including High Voltage (HV), Low Voltage (LV) and Transformer Substation works have been completed in Kofinslakrom (Koonsiakrom), Asikantia, Dajanso, Afreseni, Kramokrom (Kunsu Kramokrom), Kwasimarfo (Akwasimarfo), Asuogya, Nyamebekyere, Ohiapae, Sunkwa, Mpasaaso (Mpasaaso No. 2), Mpasaaso Nyamebekyere, Besease, Yaahene, and Nyameahyiraso communities. Meter installation works have commenced and are currently ongoing in these communities. Pre-commissioning tests have been completed and the Final Technical commissioning of the projects are expected to be conducted by end of July, 2025, following inspections by the utilities (Electricity Company of Ghana - ECG and Northern Electricity

Distribution Company – NEDCo in their respective areas of supervision/operations).

HV and LV poles planting have been completed in Damiabra (Domeabra), Mpasaaso (Mpasaso No. 2) and Nyamekyere (Mpasaaso Nyamebekyere) communities. Stringing of the HV and LV poles networks with conductors are expected to commence soon.

The Awadua Fie community however, does not form part of any of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition's ongoing electrification projects. Our checks however with the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG) indicate that the community is already connected to the national electricity grid.

[Published by order of Mr Speaker]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Question number 214, Mr Peter Lanchene Toobu, Member of Parliament for Wa West. You have the floor.

Improvement of Electricity Coverage in the Wa West District

Supt (Rtd) Peter Lanchene Toobu (Wa West): To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition when the less than 40 per cent electricity coverage of the Wa West District will be improved towards the national average, which currently stands at about 90 per cent.

Mr John Abdulai Jinapor: The Ministry of Energy and Green Transition acknowledges that the Wa West district in the Upper West region is one of the districts in the country which is

underserved with electricity access. Per the Ministry's records, electricity access in the Wa West in terms of population is currently 38.01 per cent.

The Ministry of Energy and Green Transition under the Self-Help Electrification Programme (SHEP) is currently working to extend electricity to Varempery, Meteu, Gurungu and Kawu communities in the Wa West District as part of efforts to improve electricity access in the Wa West district.

Further to the above, 45 communities have been surveyed and captured for consideration for electrification under upcoming electrification project. This project is expected to be implemented following budgetary allocation by Ministry of Finance (MoF). I want to assure my Colleague that once we get clearance from the Ministry of Finance, all these 45 communities will be prioritised and connected.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Supt (Rtd) Toobu: Mr Speaker, I am excited to hear the number 45 and I do not want to add any further questions. I am grateful to the Minister.

Thank you so much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Members, let us move to the last Question for today, the Question numbered 217 standing in the name of Hon Robert Wisdom Cudjoe, Prestea Huni-Valley.

Richard Kwami Sefe: Mr Speaker, please, I have the authority of Hon Robert Cudjoe to ask the Question on his behalf and I seek your leave.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, go ahead.

State of the Construction of the Astro Turf in Prestea Awarded in 2020 by GNPC

Mr Richard Kwami Sefe on behalf of Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (NDC — Prestea Huni-Valley): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the current state of the construction of the Astro-turf in Prestea, which was awarded by the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) Foundation in May 2020.

Mr John Abdulai Jinapor: The Prestea Astroturf project was part of the GNPC Foundation's 2019 infrastructure development initiatives. The project was originally awarded in May 2020 to Waste 360 Environment Management Services Limited, at a contract sum of GH¢ 1,599,066.00. The scope of works included site preparation, installation of artificial turf, and associated civil works.

Despite initial mobilisation and two follow-up payments totalling 90 per cent of the contract sum, the original contractor failed to complete the works. After receiving the third payment in December 2022, the contractor abandoned the site and failed to deliver the promised materials. Further investigations revealed acts of misrepresentation, including distributing

one set of artificial grass among three separate sites in a bid to secure additional payments. These findings led to the termination of the contract with Waste 360 Limited in October 2024, with support from the local traditional leadership and community stakeholders.

Following the termination, the project was re-awarded to a new contractor, Sinturf Construction Limited, at a revised contract sum of GH¢1,950,000.00, duly approved by the GNPC Foundation Board of Trustees. The new contractor has since mobilized to site, with preparatory works currently ongoing. A first payment of GH¢585,000.00 was made to Sinturf on 21st January, 2025, and the Foundation has instituted strict technical monitoring mechanisms to ensure quality delivery and timely completion.

The GNPC Foundation is committed to completing the Prestea Astroturf project without further delay. Additional measures being undertaken include:

- Strengthened due diligence for future contractor selection.
- Legal review for possible recovery of funds from the defaulting contractor.
- Enhanced monitoring and community collaboration to avoid recurrence.

The Ministry acknowledges the delays and frustrations caused by the initial contractor's failure but assures this honourable House and the good

people of Prestea that all efforts are now being made to complete the project under the supervision of the GNPC Foundation and the new contractor.

5.36 p.m.

Mr Speaker, let me assure you that the first company would be held to account and would ensure that the money is refunded. Failure to do so, I would ensure that we refer the company to the Attorney-General for prosecution.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Sefe: Mr Speaker, fortunately I have the owner of the Question around, but I do not know whether he could be permitted to pick it from here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The authority given you has not been revoked. So, a delegated function cannot further be delegated. So, you have the authority to ask the supplementary question as well.

Mr Sefe: Thank you. Let me use this opportunity to thank the Minister. However, I want to inform the Minister that the second contractor is also equally not on site. We pray that the way he has been working and everybody in Ghana is happy about it—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, be guided by order 88(7).

Mr Sefe: I would like to know from him what he can do to ginger the interest of my people to take interest in whatever or the timeline that he can give us for the new contractor to go back to site for my people to be happy.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any timeline to when the contractor will resume work?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, as Minister for the Sector, I have directed that we undertake a comprehensive overview of all these Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) projects. I intend that within two months, we should be able to conclude and so, kindly give me two months to conclude all these reviews so that we can standardise these contracts and get them running and get enough budgetary allocation as well as put in place the proper checks and balances to ensure that they are worked on, on time.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Sefe: Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you too, Hon Member.

Hon Members, Question time has ended. You have a supplementary question?

May I use the opportunity to thank the Minister for attending upon the House to respond to Questions. So, Hon Minister, thank you for coming.

Hon Members, do we move to the item numbered 8? The Minister is scheduled to brief the House. You have the floor.

STATEMENT

Response to Parliament on the 2.45 Per cent Electricity Tariffs Adjustment for Third Quarter, 2025

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor) (MP): This Statement is in respect of the 2.45 per cent electricity tariff adjustment for the third quarter 2025. The Minister of Energy respectfully provide the following explanation in respect of this tariff adjustment, which was announced by the Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC), a statutory body based on their quarterly review processes, guided by section 16 and section 20 of the PURC's Commission's Act, 1997 (Act 538), which ensures that tariffs reflect changes in key macroeconomic variables, preserve utility ability, and protect consumer interest.

Mr Speaker, as Minister, let me put on record that the PURC does not report directly to me and so when this Question or Statement was requested of me, I contacted the PURC for information and so what I present to this House is based on information that I obtained from the PURC.

The first thing has to do with the exchange rate dynamics. I am happy to note, Mr Speaker, that the Ghana cedi has appreciated by about 34 per cent against the US dollar and that is why,

contrary to what we were expecting, there was a minimal increment of 2.5 per cent contrary to the 11 per cent that was projected and so, based on the exchange rate performance, we had a positive outlook and hence, we had a low level of price increment.

Mr Speaker, our standard revenues from the PURC were about 50 per cent of unrecovered revenues from 2024, amounting to about GH¢500 million.

The reserve margin, which used not to be part of the tariff, thereby creating a huge vacuum, is gradually being absorbed as part of the tariff structure. That is why we saw this marginal increment.

In addition to that, a lot of the liquid fuels we procure were not part of the tariff structure. But cabinet directed that on an incremental basis, on a gradualist approach, we should be capturing some of these liquid fuels.

The cost of gas also went up marginally from 7.6 to 7.7. Inflation also accounted for part of the tariff structure and finally, the hydro and thermal mix. All this put together and weighted, gave us the 2.4 per cent instead of what people were predicting to be 11 pe cent.

I therefore want to say that this marginal increment was on the back of improvement on the economic front, led by Hon Ato Forson and his team.

Thank you very much. Mr Speaker

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that is the Statement from the Minister. The floor is now open for comments.

Hon Members, any comment on the Statement made by the Minister?

Yes, Hon Minister for Education?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu (NDC — Tamale South): Mr Speaker, I will indulge you to speak from here. Just to commend the Hon Minister for Energy and Mr Speaker, to share the fact that as far back as November 2023, the previous administration was adequately informed by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) that the threat to Ghana's economic stability was energy and the cocoa sector. So, the reforms the Minister for Energy and Green Transition is driving are reforms which ought to have taken place even before the end of December 2024.

In fact, Mr Speaker, at the time, the IMF predicted the debt hang in the energy sector at US\$3.1 billion, which was calculated to be 2.8 per cent of GDP. Many of these reforms, Mr Speaker, including what has now been increased as a fuel levy, is the assured way that we can deal with the rising energy debt. But Mr Speaker, my advice to the Minister is that he cannot be taking power in dollars and selling in cedis and have stability. But I commend his reforms effort, particularly the intervention to get the private sector participate in the ECG activities.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member. Any further comment?

Yes, Hon Zuwera? Very well.

Hon Members, in the absence of any further comment, may I, on your behalf, thank the Minister sincerely for coming to brief the House on this urgent matter. Hon Minister, thank you very much.

[Pause]

Deputy Majority Leader?

5.46 p.m.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Can we now move to the Commencement of Public Business and look at laying some Papers? So, can we take the item numbered 9(c), Presentation of Papers so that the Minister for Energy and Green Transition can lay a few Papers.

Thank you, Mr Speaker—

Mr Speaker, there are four items here, so if we can take them together: (i) to (iv).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, at the Commencement of Public Business, the item numbered 9(c) by the Minister for Energy and Green Transition.

PAPERS

By the Minister for Energy and Green Transition

- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Northern Electricity Distribution Company.
- (ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Electricity
- (iii) Company of Ghana for the year 2024.
- (iv) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana National Gas Company for the year 2024.
- (v) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Energy.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, it is now 9(d), but the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources has just left because—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the Minister for Education is here to take the item numbered (b).

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: All right, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered 9(b), Minister for Education—

By the Minister for Education —

- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration for the year 2024.
- (ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana School of Law for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Education.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I am sorry; I did not realise that the Minister for Education was actually here, so we can now go to 9(d) which I was seeking your indulgence to let the Minister—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is so. We would take the item numbered 9(d)(i) and (ii).

Yes, Hon Minister, leave is granted for you to lay the item numbered 9(d).

By the Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu) on behalf of the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resource

- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the State Housing Company for the year 2024.
- (ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the TDC Ghana Limited for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Works and Housing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think we should continue with what we were doing yesterday and take the item numbered 16 on the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 16 at page 8 of today's Order Paper, Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025 at Consideration Stage.

Hon Members, I think we put a Question on clause 3. So, we are now moving to clause 4.

BILLS — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Ghana Scholarships Authority, 2025

[Resumption of Consideration Stage from 16/07/2025]

Clause 4 — Governing body of the Authority

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, there is an advertised amendment for clause 4.

Mr Speaker, I beg to move subclause (1), paragraph (b), sub-paragraph (v) *delete* “Minister” and *insert* “Ministry”, to read:

“Ministry responsible for Foreign Affairs”.

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, subclause (1) after paragraph (d), *insert* a new paragraph (e) as follows:

“(e) one representative of the Student Loan Trust Fund not below the rank of a Director, nominated by the Governing body of Student Loan Trust Fund;”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will now put a Question on the entire Clause 4.

Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, there is a second thought on the Governing body. We are proposing a further amendment to include the National Union of Ghana Students because many of them are going to be affected locally and internationally. So, it is important that they are represented on the Board.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is for the consideration of the House. Yes, Minister for Education?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if I may indulge you and the Chairman of Committee, so that on the entire clause 4, you stay the Question while we proceed with other clauses.

The Office of the President drew my attention this morning to two important petitions from the Coalition of Civil Society Organisations in Education led by Kofi Asare and the NUGS President. Mr Speaker, I engaged both individuals before attending upon this House this afternoon.

Mr Speaker, legislation as I understand it, public input is important and the input of stakeholders is important. And we want a Scholarships Authority Bill that serves the people of Ghana well.

The Chairman, even at Committee level—Mr Speaker, if you would recall,

your good self was present and even questioned whether we did not want National Union of Ghana Students (NUGS) to be on the Governing Board. We exchanged it and said that, maybe, the Student Loan Trust Fund could also be allowed to be on this Board.

Mr Speaker, I am further consulting with the stakeholders and if I can indulge you, we can look at the other clauses while I still engage and come back. But the Government is open to accommodating—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

We defer the question on clause 4.

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, I made the proposal that we make NUGS part of the Governing board, so I still move.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, there is no objection. You can direct the draftspersons to, maybe, replace—Gender is covered in (f).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Chairman of the Committee, having listened to the Minister for Education, I intend to defer the Question on the entire Clause 4 because the Minister for Education wants to conduct a further consultation.

Clause 5 — Functions of the Board.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, there is no advertised amendment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is, however, for the consideration of the House.

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie, clause 5.

5.56p.m.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with your leave, may I seek clarity from the Chairman of the Committee on sub-clause (b) and with your leave, I quote:

“determine the criteria and terms for the award of Government scholarships;”

I think that, in order to enhance clarity, do we not need to qualify the criteria by saying “eligibility”. So, we could *insert* a qualifying word to read:

“determine the eligibility criteria and terms for the award of Government scholarship”

If that would not be injurious, then I propose that we insert that, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Member, “criteria” and “eligibility” are they the same words? But it is open for Members.

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, I will appeal to my Colleague to abandon it because “eligibility” and “criteria” are all the same.

Mr Ebenezer Okletay Terlarbi: Mr Speaker, I think they are not the same. The criteria will lead to eligibility.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, does the criteria not talk about the means or the method, while eligibility talks about qualification?

Dr Godfred Seidu Jasaw: Mr Speaker, we can allow it to stay like this because if we go further, at clause 25, it actually talks about the “eligibility criteria”. So, that is dealt properly with under clause 25, so we can leave this to stay as it is.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, is that not the more reason we must do it for the sake of consistency?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, are you making reference to clause 25? In that case, for consistency, the Hon Member is right.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Ing Surv Maxwell Kwame Lukutor: Mr Speaker, I would also want to seek clarity from the Chairman on clause 5(e) and it says:

“monitor and evaluate accountability of funds of the Authority; and”

I am not too sure what that means, so if the Chairman could help me further understand to know whether there is a need to—I do not know if it is the drafting language, but I want to understand from the Chairman.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee, is it to

monitor the use of the fund or accountability of the fund?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think our Colleague has a point.

“monitor and evaluate the use of and ensure accountability of funds of the Authority.”

I would co-join it, the way I have stated it. They will “monitor and evaluate the use of funds”, but ensure “the use and ensure accountability of the funds”. If we marry it, we are only strengthening the accountability of the use of the funds. Mr Speaker, you may want to direct the draftspersons to get the language.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, should it read, “monitor and evaluate the use and accountability of the fund”?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: All right, Hon Shaibu is a more modern-day draftsperson like Mr Speaker, so—

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I just want to entreat the Minister to abandon the word “ensure”, so that it reads:

“monitor and evaluate the use of and accountability”

We can take out the first “of” or we could leave it and take out the second “of” instead. So, it will be:

“monitor and evaluate the use and accountability of the funds of the Authority”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, the question the Member asked is, how do you monitor and evaluate accountability? The Minister is saying that you have to ensure accountability, so you “monitor the use of the fund and ensure accountability”.

Mr S. Mahama: Very well, Mr Speaker. So, it will be “the use and ensure accountability of the funds”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Ing Surv Lukutor: Mr Speaker, I want to suggest that we break this into two, so that first of all, we think about “monitor the use of the funds”, then the next one may be “to ensure accountability”, so that it is two different clauses.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, once we have the sense of the House, I would urge the draftspersons to put it in a proper drafting language for us.

Hon Members, any further amendment to clause 5? I would then put the Question on the entire clause 5.

Clause 5 as amended is ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 6 — Duties and liabilities of a member of the Board.

Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan: Mr Speaker, I wish to make this humble proposal. Clause 6(2)(c) reads:

“avoid making use of information required by virtue of the position of

the member so as to benefit that member...”

Mr Speaker, I wish to add either “directly or indirectly” just to strengthen that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, if “directly or indirectly” is not there, it could be interpreted to mean “directly or indirectly”

6.06 p.m.

Mr A. Alhassan: I am guided, Mr Speaker.

Clause 6 to 8 ordered to stand part of the Bill

Clause 9 — Disclosure of interest

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, there is no advertised amendment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is for the consideration of the House. Hon Members, any proposed amendment?

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I just want to find out from the Chairman, subclause 1 (a), and I quote,

“A member of the Board who has an interest in a matter for consideration

(a) shall disclose in writing the nature of that interest and the

disclosure shall form part of the record of the consideration of the matter.”

Mr Speaker, there is a view that the moment a member of the Board writes and openly declares that he has an interest, that is rather a conduit for his interest to be protected. I do not know if he is getting me. *[Interruption]* I cannot hear him well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, at what point really are you raising?

Mr Afriyie: Well, Mr Speaker, respectfully, I was just trying to find out if we can have a better way for members of the board to declare their interest in the event of a possible conflict of interest, rather than writing and making members of the board aware. *[Interruption]* Can I please? I am only seeking education, anyway.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, by what means do you want a member to disclose his interest?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, we are using this process to also learn. Since I have seniors, I am floating the idea.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, but do you have a suggestion on how a member could disclose his interest?

Mr Afriyie: Well, sometimes one would just recuse oneself, if one is a member of the board—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, if you are a member of the board and the board is deliberating on an issue, before they

realise, you are no longer in the boardroom. So, do you want the board to assume that because you have an interest in the matter, that is why you left the boardroom?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, respectfully, that is also not the way I am contemplating. There should be a better way for the board to report to, I think, the Minister and some other forces. So, one would report his absence from the board in such a manner that would not even let members know that the person has an interest. That is what I was trying to bring to the fore.

Mr Speaker, indulge me a bit. If I am a member of the board and my colleague is also a member, then my daughter is supposed to come for an interview for a scholarship, then I say I am recusing myself because my daughter is coming for an interview, I think that it is a way of telling members to consider my daughter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, there are others who have been members of the board. So, they can share their experience as to how this thing is done at the board level.

Yes, Hon Shaibu Mahama?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, my Colleague's apprehension should be allayed. So, it is rather when it is not disclosed that a decision is taken. Then the contemplation would be that, after all, he even hid and told some people

about this. That is why it says that disclosure should even be in writing. Once it is written and the person says that yes, he has got his daughter who has applied to be considered for a scholarship because of that, he will not sit in the meeting. So, the person has written to them.

Remember, they are professionals. They are looking at credentials, accessibility, location of the candidate and many other factors. So, if a person's daughter qualifies under all those conditions, it is a clear testimony to say that, yes, the person has a written report that says that he wants to do a disclosure and because of that, he does not want to sit in. Mr Speaker, it is standard. We have debated it many times and have agreed that this is how it should be captured.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Thank you so much.

Clause 9 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clauses 10 to 16 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 17 — Secretary to the Board.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, there is one advertised amendment.

Sub-clause 1, *delete* and *insert* as follows:

“(1) The Director-General shall designate a staff of the Authority as Secretary to the Board.” I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is for the consideration of the House.

Yes, Hon Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah?

Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I was just wondering if any staff, including a driver, who is also a staff, can be designated as secretary to the board. I think we should qualify that staff. Because if we say the director-general should designate anybody, it could be a driver, a messenger who is a staff of the institution.

6.16 p.m.

So let us qualify it so that we can have proper designation for the Secretary.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I have looked at this particular clause. If the proposed amendment is to stay, you need to task the Director-General with the responsibility of being the Secretary to the Board. If it is not, you can ask him to delegate. However, if he is just going to straightforward designate a staff, what should be the qualification of the staff that he will be designating?

Yes, Hon Shaibu?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: In recent legislations, we have not been too straightforward. There are some

legislations where we have created it as a separate clause and I think that senior Bedzrah’s concern looks a bit legitimate. I think we should be specific and perhaps even indicate what the qualification or criteria should be going forward and if we would use this one to look at it then that would be fine.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: There are three main ways of doing this; One, you are creating a secretariat completely to perform this particular function. Then two, you are asking the Director-General to be the Secretary and giving an opportunity to the Director-General to delegate and even where that function is delegated, he is not taken off from any obligations. And then the next way of doing it is to designate a staff. Probably, if they have a legal department, then they say the head of legal should be designated to perform this function.

Yes?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, there is no policy objection. We can provide that there shall be a Secretary to the Board who shall also be a legal counsel to the Board. So, if you can direct the drafters, there is no objection. We can create it. Let us create that there is a Secretary to the Board who shall be a person with 10 years’ experience in law and then you ask the drafters to put it there. Because this is the first time we are having this Authority. So, it is good to strengthen the institution. I think that we should create it, that there shall be a Secretary to the Board who should be somebody with at least 10 years standing in the law.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, I will advise that we defer clause 17 and ask the drafters to give us a proper rendition for the consideration of the House.

So accordingly, clause 17 is also deferred.

Clause 18 ordered to stand as part of the Bill.

Clause 19 — Internal Audit Unit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, there is no advertised amendment. It is for the consideration of the House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah?

Mr Bedzrah: Mr Speaker, yes, indeed, there is no amendment, but I thought that we would have an audit committee under clause 19. Unfortunately, we do not have any audit committee. We have already looked at the committees where we have finance committee without audit committee. I believe that every Board—the recent Boards, have audit committees that look at the internal audits of the various institutions. I do not know where we can make provision for an internal audit committee within this Authority.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, have you looked at clause 19, subclauses (4) and (5)?

Mr Bedzrah: Mr Speaker, yes, you submit it to the Board. It is the internal audit that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Look at subclause (4) first.

Mr Bedzrah: I was talking about—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It reads, “...Subject to subsections (3) and (4) of the section 16 of the Internal Audit Agency Act, 2003 (Act 658) at intervals of three months

- (a) prepare and submit to the Board, a report...
- (b) make recommendations in each report with respect to...”

Mr Bedzrah: Mr Speaker, indeed, this report will be submitted to the Board, but if the Board has a subcommittee just as we have the finance committee under clause 10, that Committee will look at the Internal Auditor’s Report and then submit the same to the Board. But this one, the internal auditors will submit it directly to the Board, and the Board will refer it to who?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you want clause 10 to be amended to establish—

Mr Bedzrah: Audit committee. In fact—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Board audit—

Mr Bedzrah: I was going through to see whether we have audit committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We do not.

Mr Bedzrah: We do not have.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Mr Bedzrah: And this is an Authority that will be dealing with funds, just as we have with GETFund which has internal audit committee as a subcommittee under the Board. So, I am just making reference to that in essence.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Ing Surv Maxwell Lukutor: Mr Speaker, clause 23, subclause (2), it reads,

“The Board shall, at the end of each financial year, submit the accounts of the Authority to the Auditor-General for audit”.

I do not know whether that should be different from what the Hon Member is proposing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, what he is proposing is that there should be a Board subcommittee. Yes. So that is what is baffling me, that if they have internal audit unit, why would they again have a Board subcommittee on internal audit? *[Pause]*

Hon Shaibu Mahama?

Mr Mahama: Mr Speaker, to take Hon Bedzrah’s suggestion on board, we could go back to clause 10, where we have the establishment of committees, and where we were specific about (a), (b), (c), assessment, committee, monitoring, evaluation, finance, we may add audit committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What will happen is that—

Mr Mahama: Under clause 10 (4).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We should do that properly within the Rules and take it out within a second consideration.

Mr Mahama: Very well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: This really is not a matter that should feature in clause 19, but rather in clause 10. Then I will put a question on clause 19.

Clause 19 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 20 — Funds of the Authority.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee.

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, we have two proposed amendments. I beg to move clause 20, paragraph (b), *delete* “and” *insert* “up to 2% of the total oil revenue”.

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is for the consideration of the House.

6.26 p.m.

Mr A. Alhassan: Mr Speaker, I think it should be “up to” but if you look at what has been advertised as the amendment, it is “up”. But the rendition should be, “up to two per cent...”. That is clause 20(b).

Mr Speaker, so I wish to propose that we add “to”.

[Pause]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, in view of the fact that 20 is the beginning of the financial provisions, do we end at clause 19 or should we finish up to clause 24? —Very well.

Hon Members, the amendment proposes to clause 2. Before “to”, insert “up to”.

Hon Members, do we leave this to the draftspersons? No, that is clause 20. We are now on clause 20. There is a proposed amendment to clause 20(b). Instead of 2 per cent of total oil revenue, the rendition will now be “up to 2 per cent”.

Hon Members, we normally say, “not more than 2 per cent”.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I did not see that one at Cabinet—*[Laughter]*—I do not remember the last time we allocated oil revenue to anything in this House without the Minister for Finance

expressly saying so. It would have been a good idea, but even to say 0.1 per cent, I do not know how the oil revenue is. So, can we just step this particular amendment down for now.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I am aware because I never missed any Cabinet meeting and I did not see this one.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: This particular Bill is a Government Bill.

Mr Abodza: Yes, I agree and I know the importance of it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

The proposal is to defer clause 20.

Mr Agbodza: That is my view, so that we confer with the Minister for Finance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, clause 20 accordingly deferred.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, clause 20, ordinarily, if you look at 20(c)—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, clause 20 has been deferred. So, why are you making proposal to a deferred clause?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: It is just to add to that deferral.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, the entire clause 20 has been deferred.

Clause 21 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 22 — Expenses of the Authority.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, as I indicated earlier, the Office of the President related to me some concerns that have been communicated; therefore, Mr Speaker, I sought the indulgence of the Chairman if we can stay further consideration, as I do the consultation as I indicated.

On Tuesday, we engaged the Coalition of Civil Society Groups in Education. But to respond to my Colleague, the Minister for Roads and Highways, this Bill was referred to a Cabinet sub-committee and subsequent to the Cabinet sub-committee, it came to Cabinet and Cabinet took a decision on it and there is formal communication on the matter.

If we do not assure this Authority of any sustainable financing, then we will have the same problem we have. Ghanaian students have been sent home all over the world for our inability to service their fees. But I will defer as he said. It has fiscal implications. He is right on that, but this Bill is a product of Cabinet and a product of Cabinet sub-committee. It was thoroughly discussed and brought to Cabinet the same day Cabinet approved the Interstate Succession Bill and one other Bill that was driven by the Minister for the Interior.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, the meat of the issue will be from clause 25 onwards. I believe the Accounts and audits, Annual report and other reports—So, Hon Minister, can we stop at clause 24?

So, Hon Minister, clause 22 accordingly deferred. Very well.

So, we will stop at clause 21 and, for today, we have come to the end of Consideration Stage of the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025.

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I am not sure we have done five hours yet. So, I want to actually ask if we can adjourn the House to tomorrow 10 o'clock in the morning.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, Motion moved for adjournment. Any seconder?

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, I second the Motion for adjournment and tomorrow, I pray, it should be the same.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 6.35 p.m. till Friday, 18th July, 2025, at 10.00 a.m.

